



Illinois Extension

UNIVERSITY OF ILLINOIS URBANA-CHAMPAIGN



CRETE COMMUNITY SURVEY RESULTS

Department of Recreation, Sport & Tourism

Office of Recreation and Park Resources

University of Illinois Extension

Introduction and Purpose of Survey

- Obtain input from Crete Residents on:
 - **Satisfaction** with the village and township of Crete
 - Assess resident **opinions of priorities for capital improvement projects**
 - **Use of Crete library** facilities, events and programs
 - **Use of CPD parks**, facilities, events, and programs
 - **Condition** of parks and facilities and evaluation of programs
 - Understand **reasons for not using** Crete parks, library, events, and services
 - Obtain a **demographic profile** of users and non-users
- Insights will contribute to strategic planning for all Crete municipal agencies

Research Methods

- Survey developed collaboratively by UIUC ORPR Staff and Crete Township, Village of Crete, Crete Park District and Crete Public Library
- Valid and reliable survey questions were used
- Stratified random sample of 5,000 households in Crete invited to participate
- Survey postcard mailed twice – second one to non-respondents
- Survey link & QR code was emailed to current and past participants and shared via signs and social media

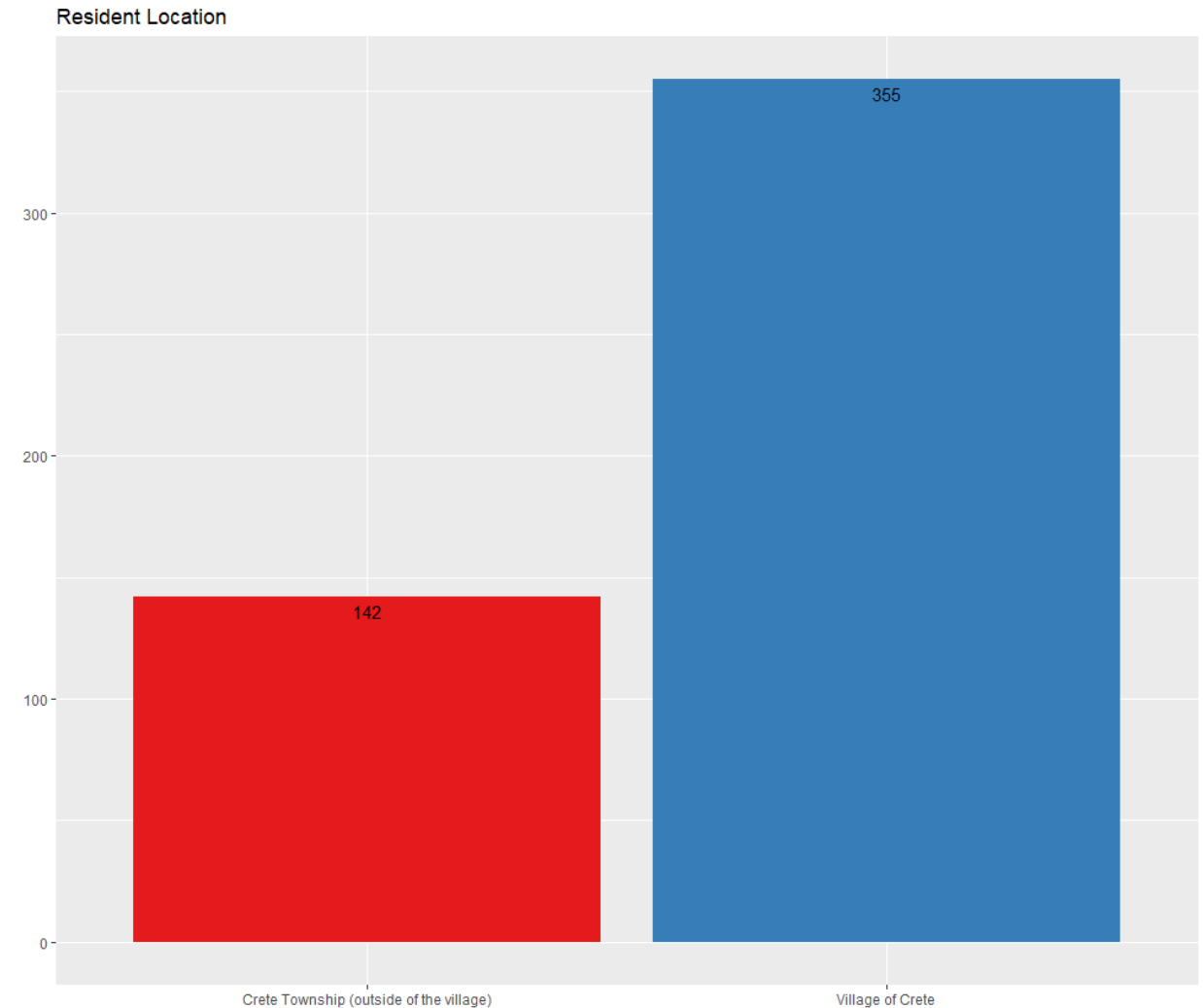


Research Methods

- 497 valid responses for a 12% response rate:
 - 30% of respondents from email list, 30% from random sample and the rest from social media, websites, and signs
 - 95% confidence we only have 5% error in the results (consistent with industry standards)
 - These groups are similar on key demographics (age, gender, length of residence)
 - Respondents from random sample more likely to be non-users of Crete public services

Description of the Sample: Resident Location

- 71% of respondents live in the Village of Crete
 - 29% live outside the village in the Township



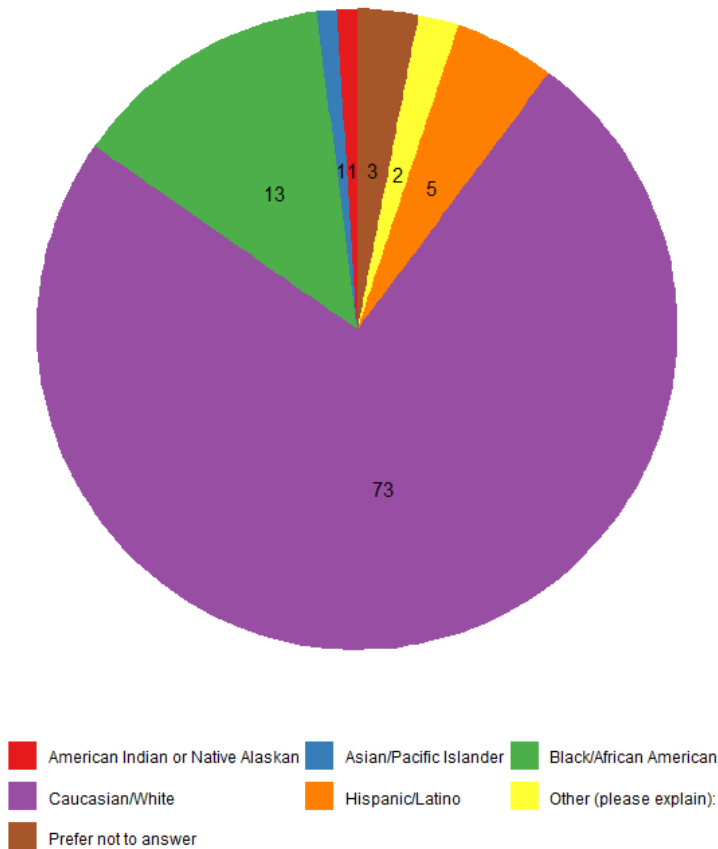
Sample Description: Age and Years Lived in Crete/Crete Township

- Sample average age of 50.7
- Mean age in Crete = 49 Years (US Census)
- Respondents ranged from 20 – 94
- 25% of respondents were 65+
 - 27% of Crete residents are 65+ (US Census)
- Average time lived in Crete was 22 years



Sample Description: Gender & Race/Ethnicity

Ethnicity

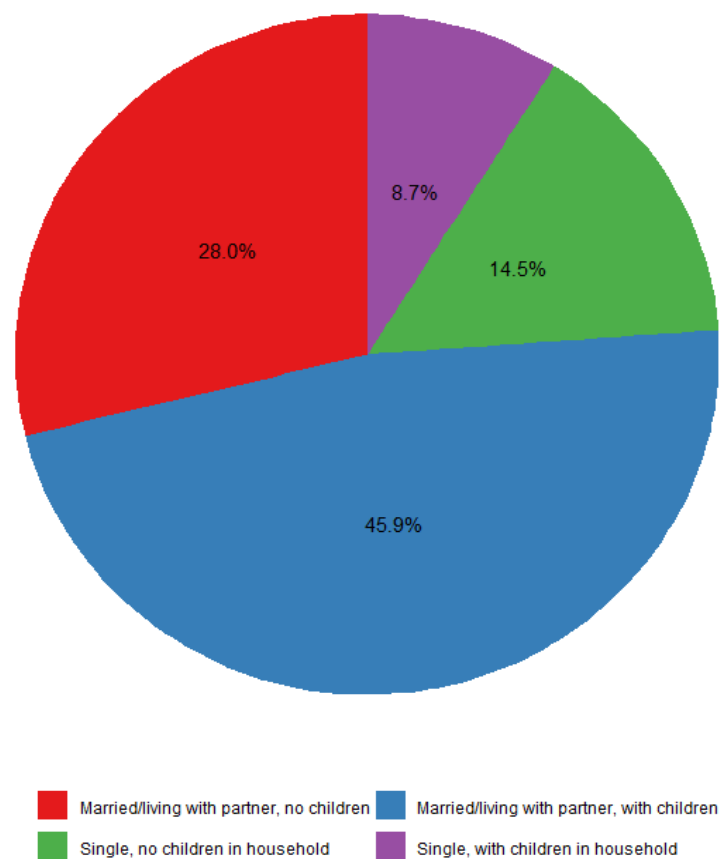


- Females overrepresented in sample (58%) vs 53% of Crete residents (Census)
- Sample was primarily white (73%) with other groups represented
 - 13% Black (31% Census)
 - 5% Hispanic (8% Census)
- 3% preferred not to answer

Marital Status and Number in the Household

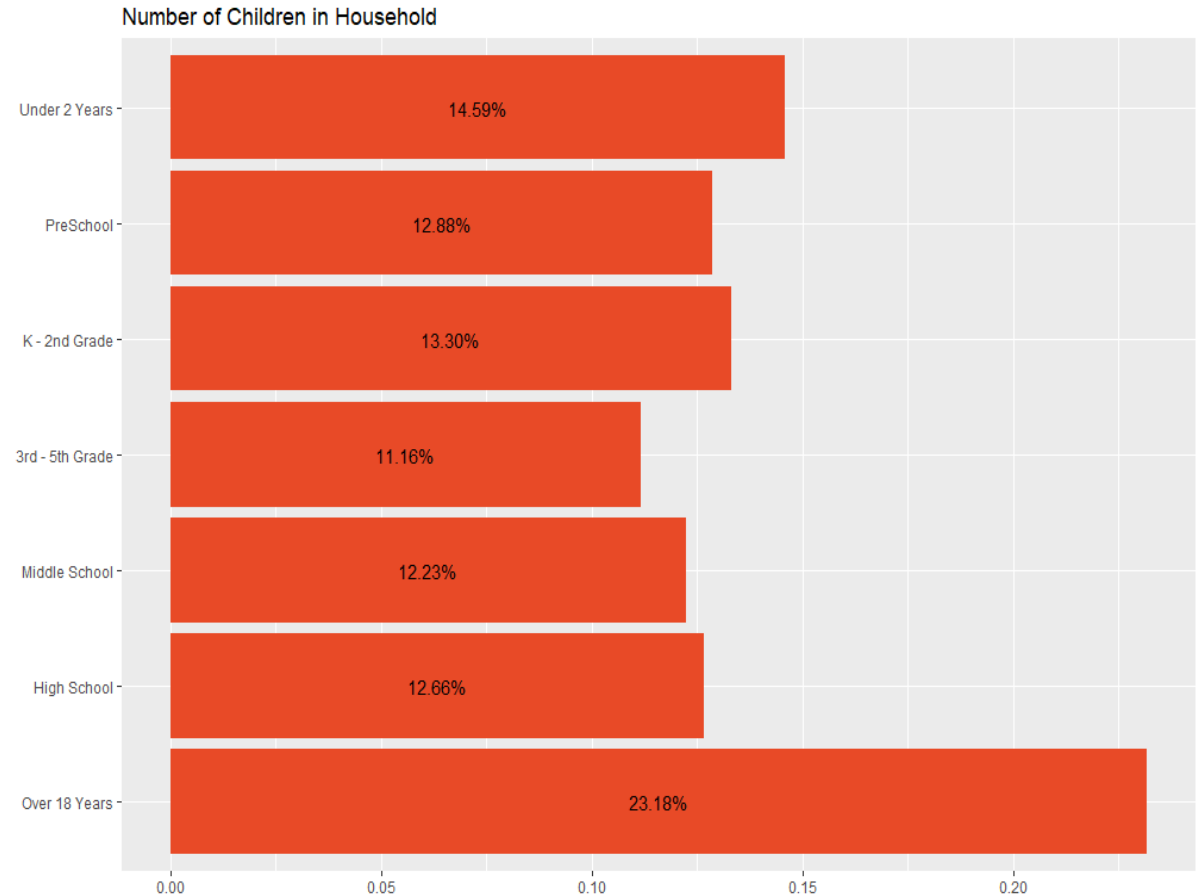
- Average household size
 - 2.4 people sample
 - Range 1 – 8
 - 2.5 people (Census)
- 74% of respondents are married/living with partner
- 54.6% of respondents have children in their household
 - Only 9% are single parents

Household Type



Children in the Household

- 23% have a child at home over 18 years old
- 14.6% are under 2 years old
- 13.3% Kindergarten – 2nd grade
- 12.8% Preschool age
- 12% HS and middle school aged
- 11% 3rd to 5th grade

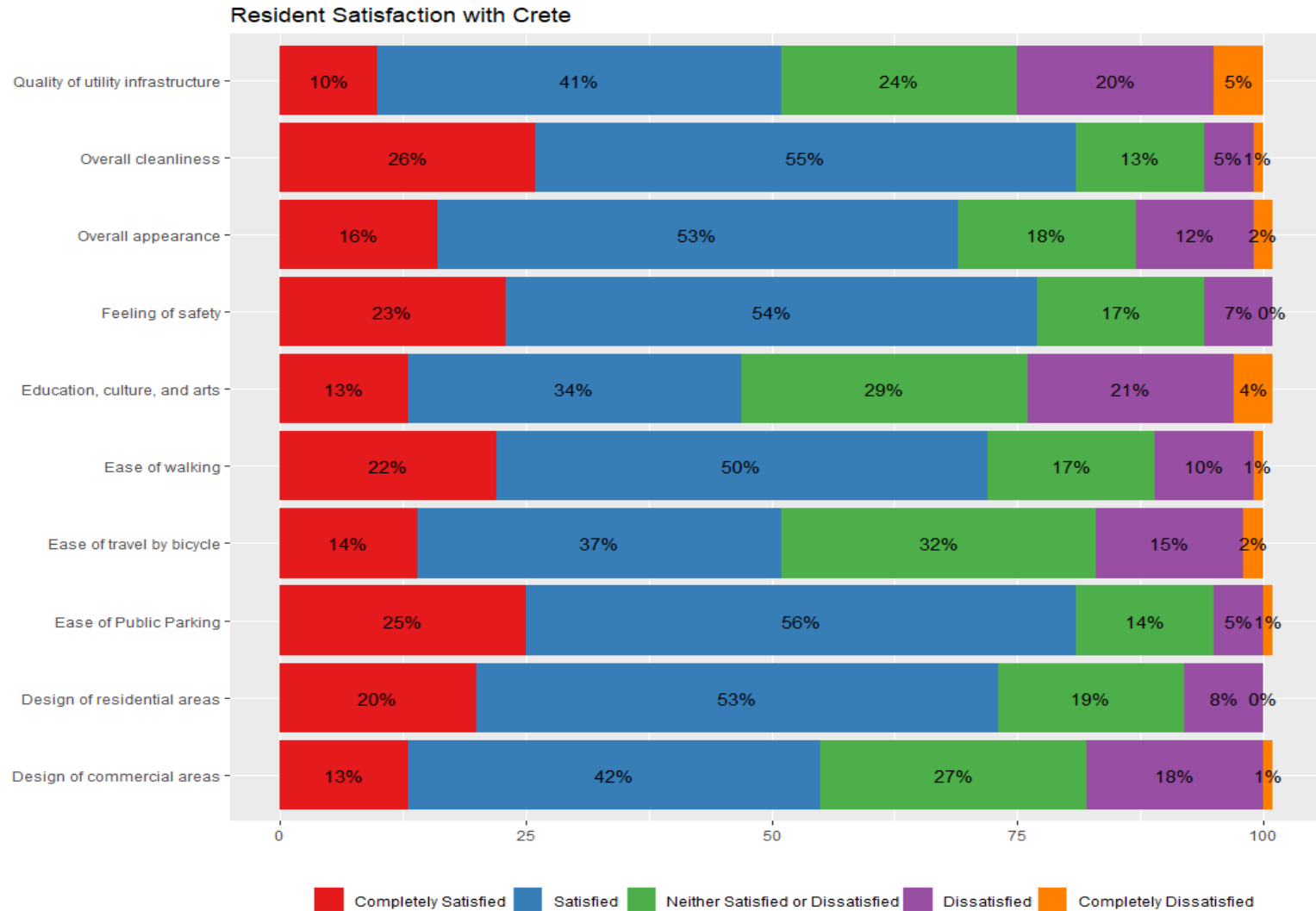




Crete Township

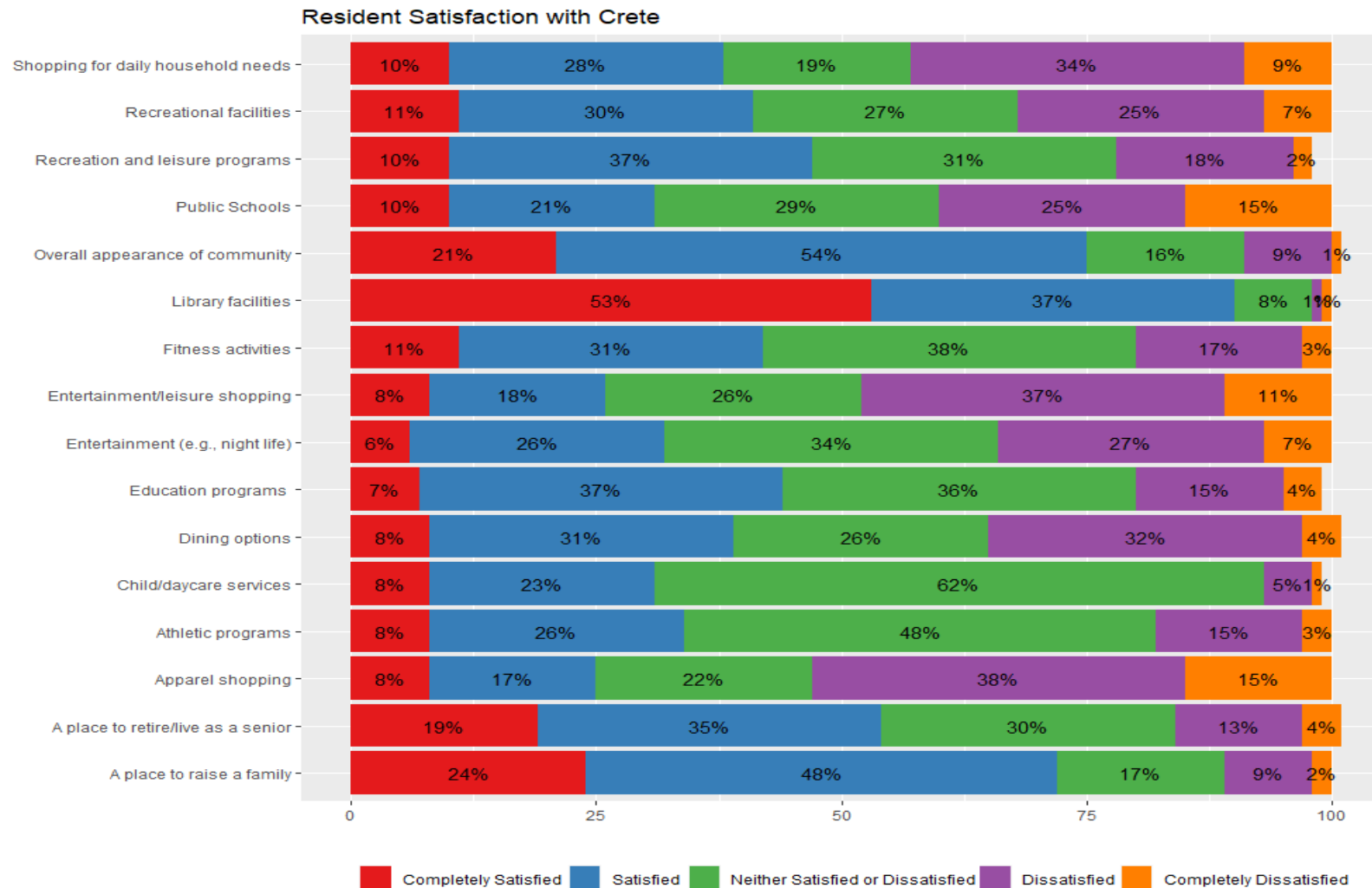
Community Development and Quality of Life

Resident Satisfaction with Crete



- Crete is viewed as safe by respondents (0% were completely dissatisfied)
- Respondents had favorable ratings about the cleanliness of Crete (81% satisfied)
- Residents are satisfied with public parking in Crete (81% satisfied)
- Room for improvement:
 - Education, culture & arts
 - Design of commercial areas
 - Ease of transport by bicycle
 - Quality of utility infrastructure

Resident Satisfaction with Community Life



Most residents were satisfied with community life in Crete, particularly with:

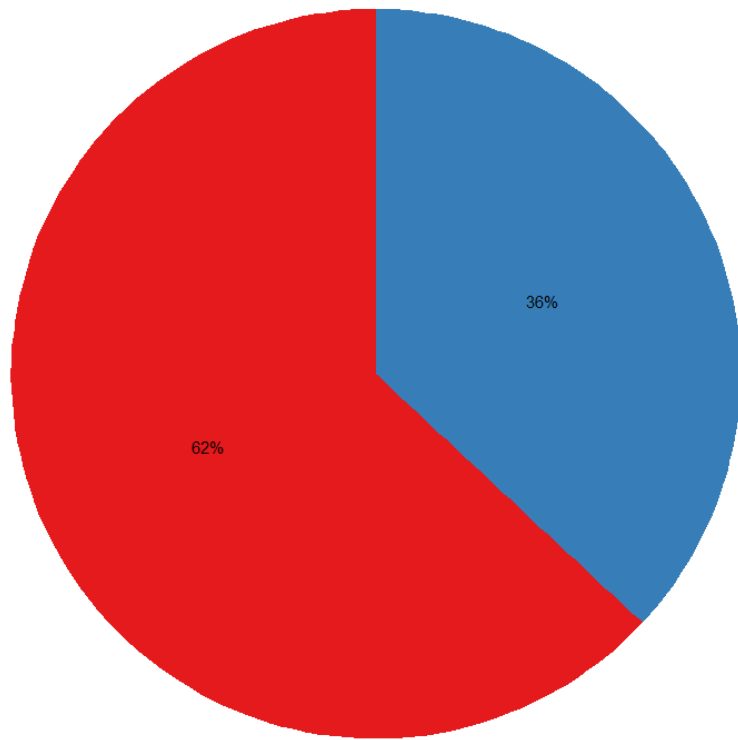
- Library facilities
- Community appearance
- Place to raise a family

Many respondents were dissatisfied with the availability of:

- Apparel (52% dissatisfied)
- Shopping for daily household needs (43%)
- Public Schools (40%)
- Dining options (36%)
- Entertainment (34% dissatisfied)
- Recreational facilities (32%)

Moved to Crete within the last 10 years

Moved to Crete within last 10 years



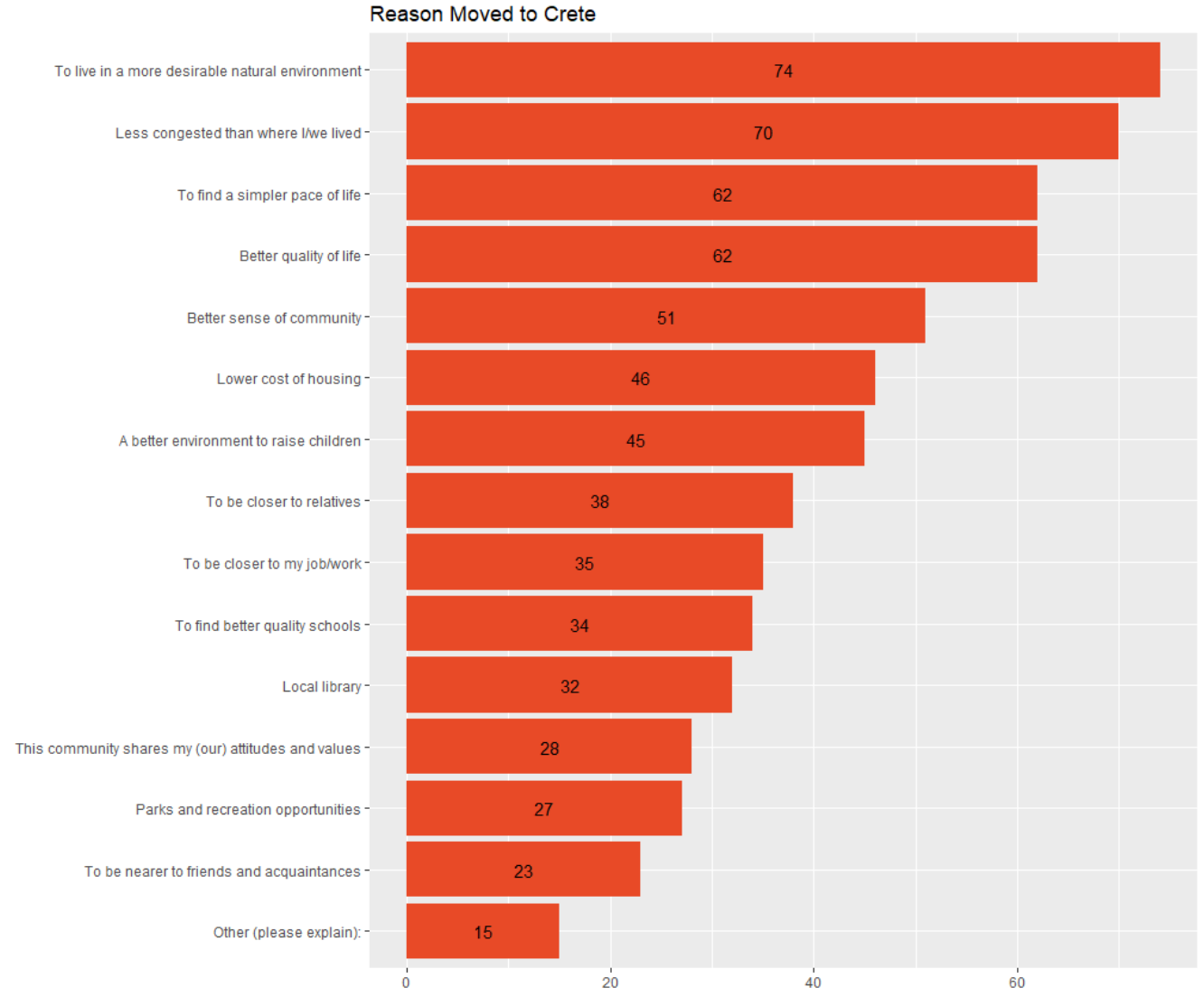
■ No ■ Yes

- Only 36 % of respondents have moved to Crete in the past 10 years
- Over 60% of respondents have lived in Crete for over a decade

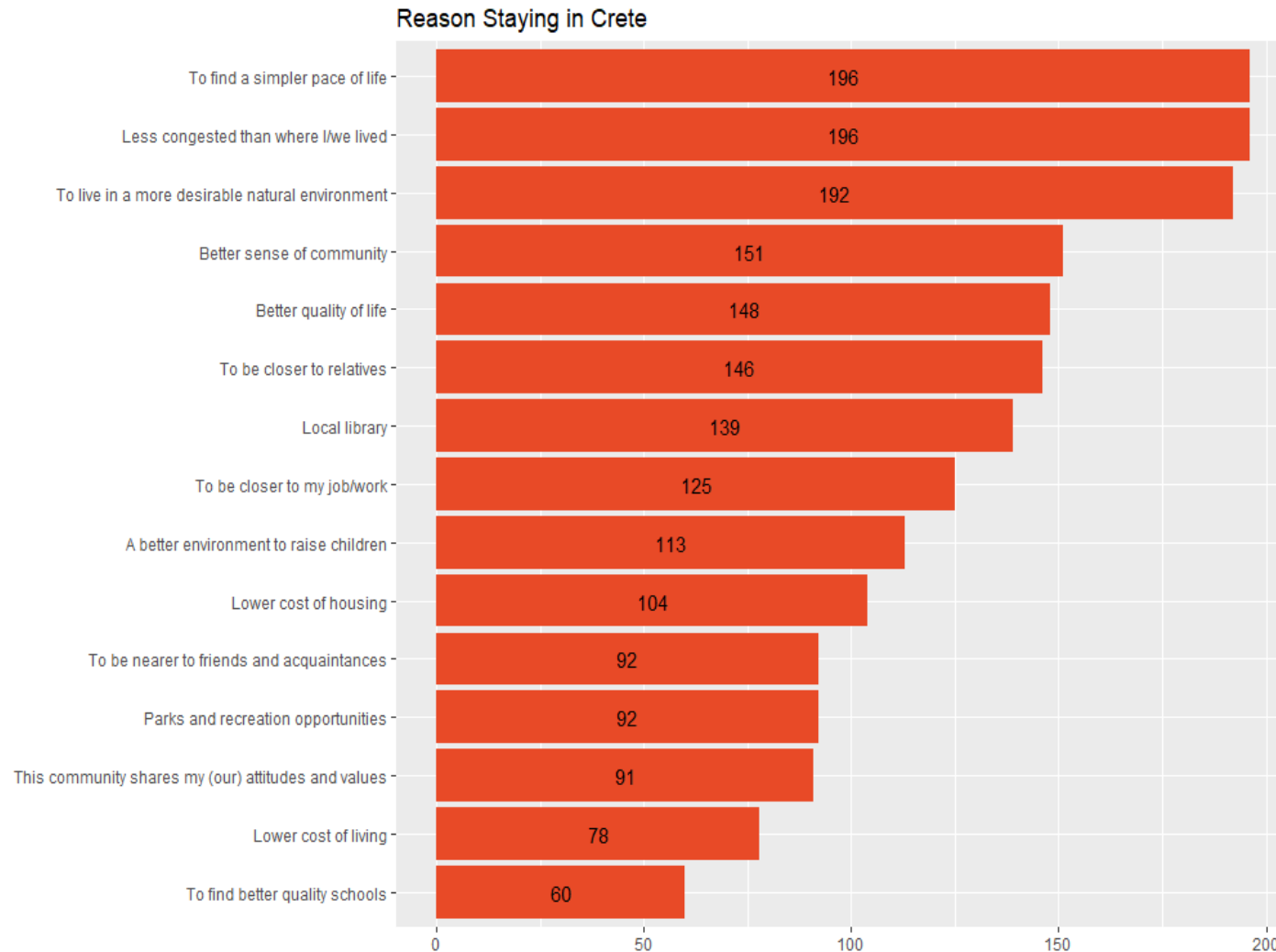
Reason for Moving to Crete

Top reasons for moving to Crete include

- Living in a more desirable natural environment
- Less congestion
- Simpler pace of life
- Better quality of life
- Improved sense of community
- Lower cost of housing
- Better environment to raise children



Reasons for staying in the Crete Area

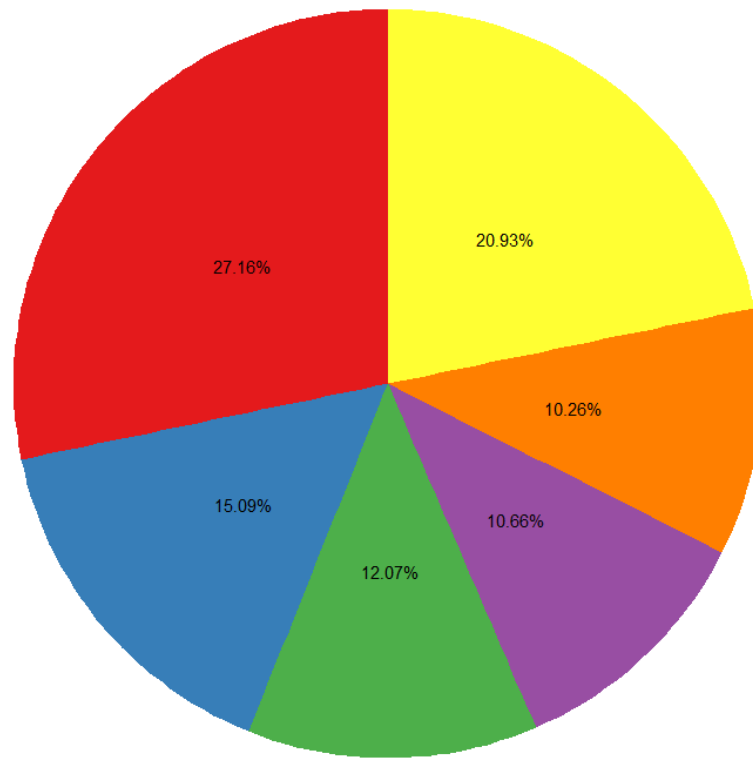


Reasons for staying in Crete are the same as reasons for moving to Crete but with differing order with the top five being:

- Simpler pace of life
- Less congestion
- More desirable natural environment
- Better sense of community
- Better quality of life
- To be closer to relatives
- The local library
- To be closer to my job/work

Likelihood of Working in Crete

Work in Crete



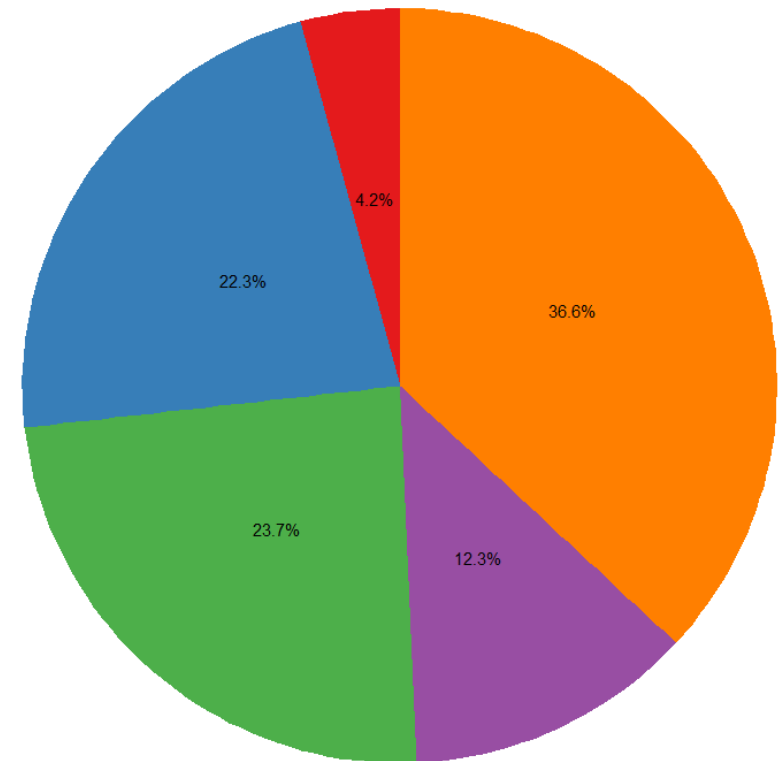
Definitely Likely I already work in Crete Probably Not Likely
Don't Know Not Likely Somewhat Likely

- Nearly half (48%) of respondents would likely work in Crete if they could find a job that matched their career field and level
- 12% of respondents already worked in Crete
- Only 20% of respondents were not likely to switch to a job in Crete if one were available

Likelihood of Living in Crete in 5 Years

- The majority (59%) of respondents planned to stay in Crete over the next 5 years
- Only 16% of respondents did not expect to live in Crete in the next 5 years
- Nearly a quarter (24%) of respondents were not sure either way

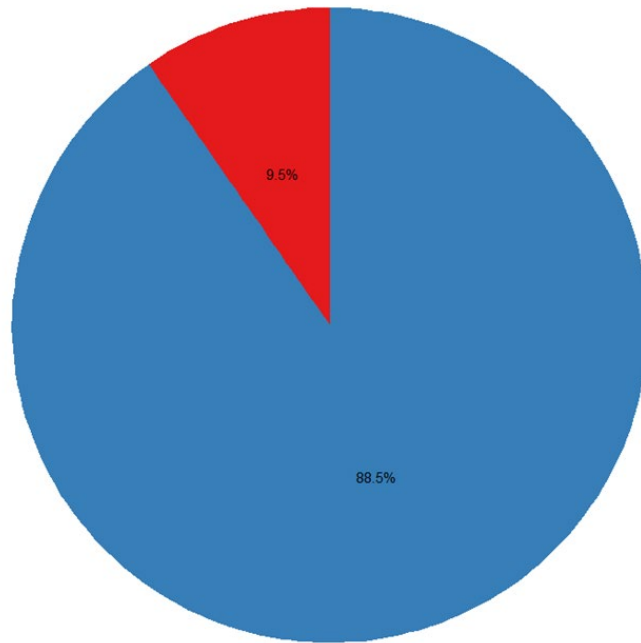
In Crete in Five Years



Use of Trash and Recycling

Trash Pickup – 88.5% Use

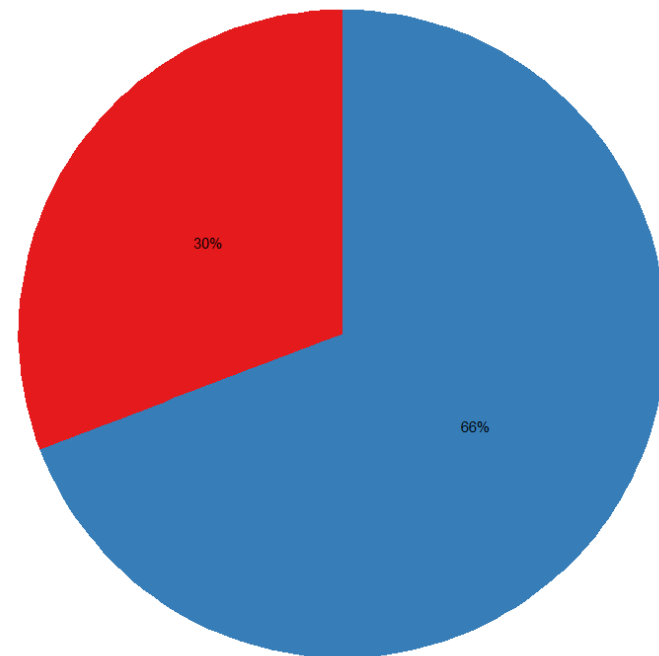
Trash Pickup Use



■ No ■ Yes

Recycling – 60% use

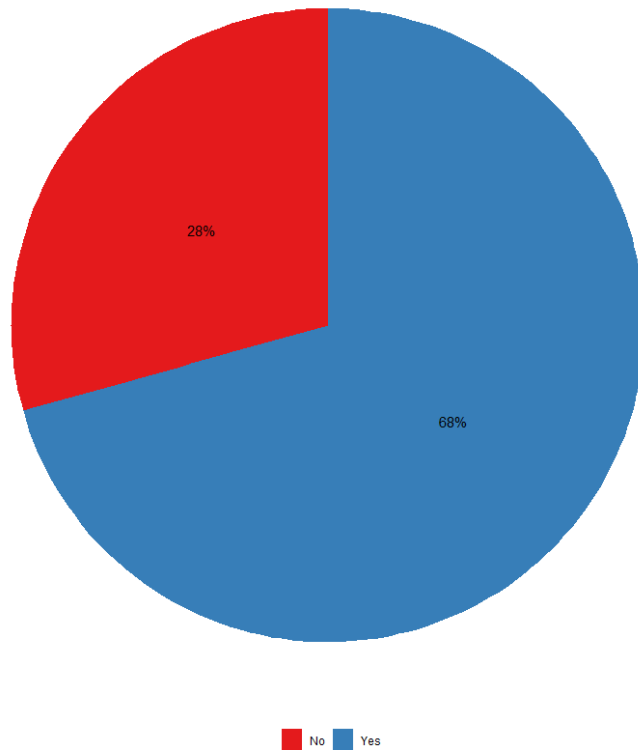
Recycling Use



■ No ■ Yes

Use of Yard Waste Services

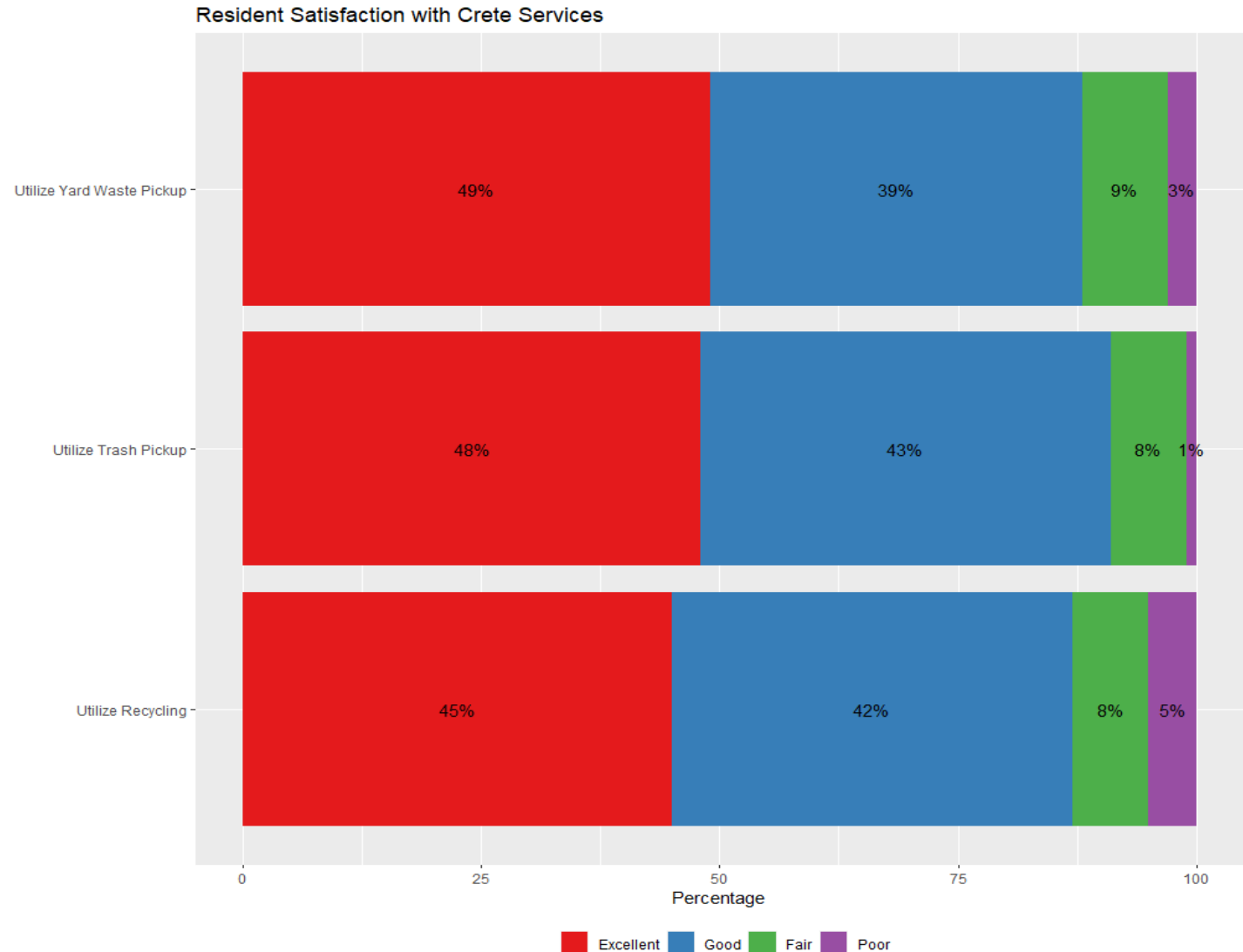
Yard Waste Use



- Over 60% of respondents use the yard waste services in Crete

Evaluation of Trash, Recycling, and Yard Waste

- Services provided in Crete are viewed favorably by residents with each services having over an 85% positive rating

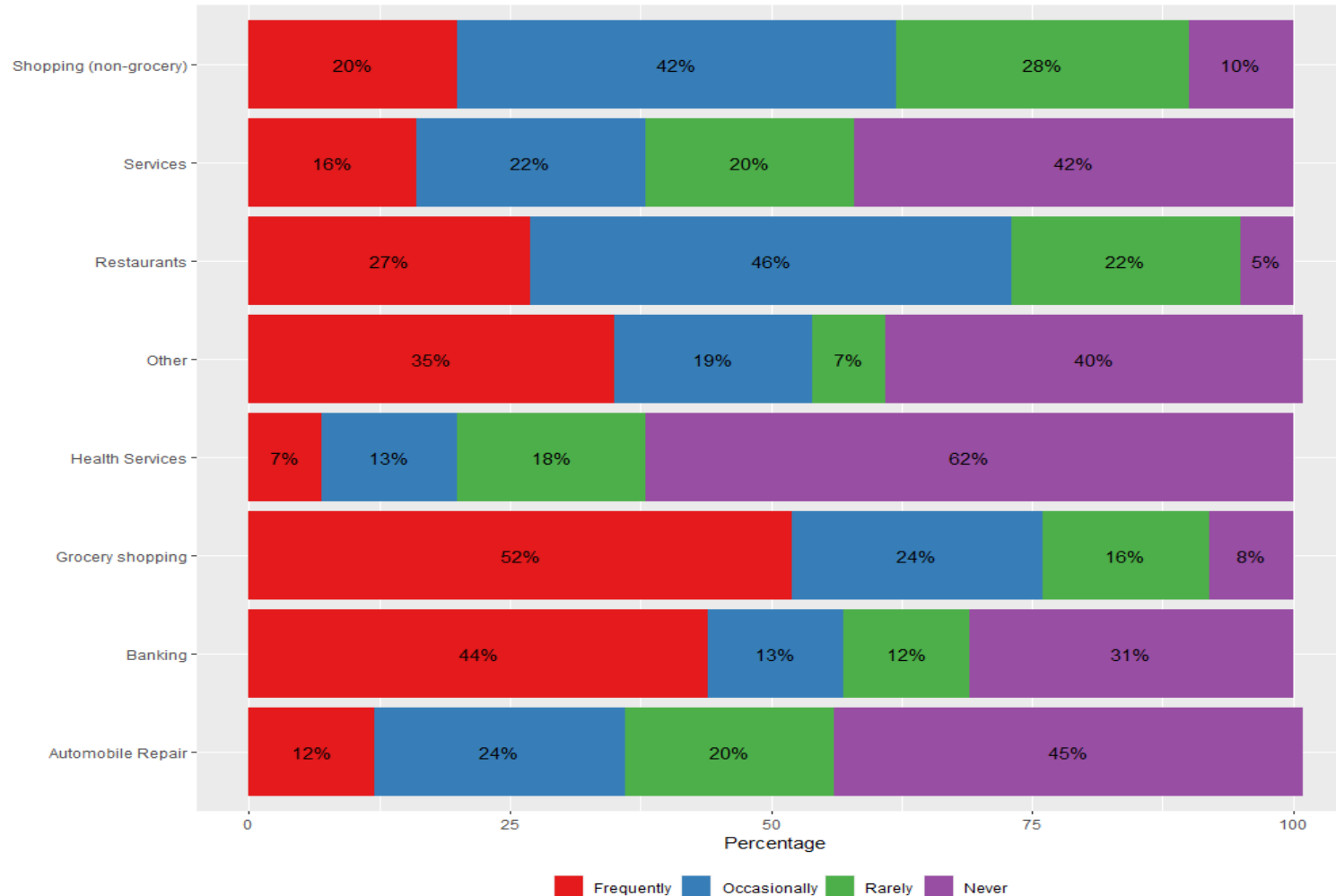


Types of Businesses that would be Supported in Crete

- **General Merchandise Store** (Walmart = 53, Target = 94, Retail = 14, Clothing = 115, Department Store = 10, Costco = 17, Sam's club = 3) = **306 total**
- **Restaurant** = (Restaurant = 133, Dining = 30, Portillo's = 19, Fast Food = 15, Chick-Fil-A = 9, Panera = 14, Bakery = 37, Other = 15) = **total 272**
- **Grocery Store** = (Grocery = 123, Aldi = 44, Trader Joe's = 19, Mariano's = 11, Super Market = 35, Whole Foods = 6, Meijer = 21) = **259 total**
- **Drug Store/Pharmacy** (Drug Store = 15, Pharmacy = 38, CVS = 7, Walgreens = 12) = **72 total**
- **Coffee Shop** (Coffee Shop = 63, Starbucks = 3, Dunkin Donuts = 6) = **72 total**
- **Home Improvement Store** (Farm & Fleet = 14, Rural King = 4, Home Depot = 18, Lowes = 1) = **37 total**
- **Pet Store** = 23
- **GYM** (Gym = 9, Planet Fitness = 6) = **15**

Frequency of Shopping in Crete

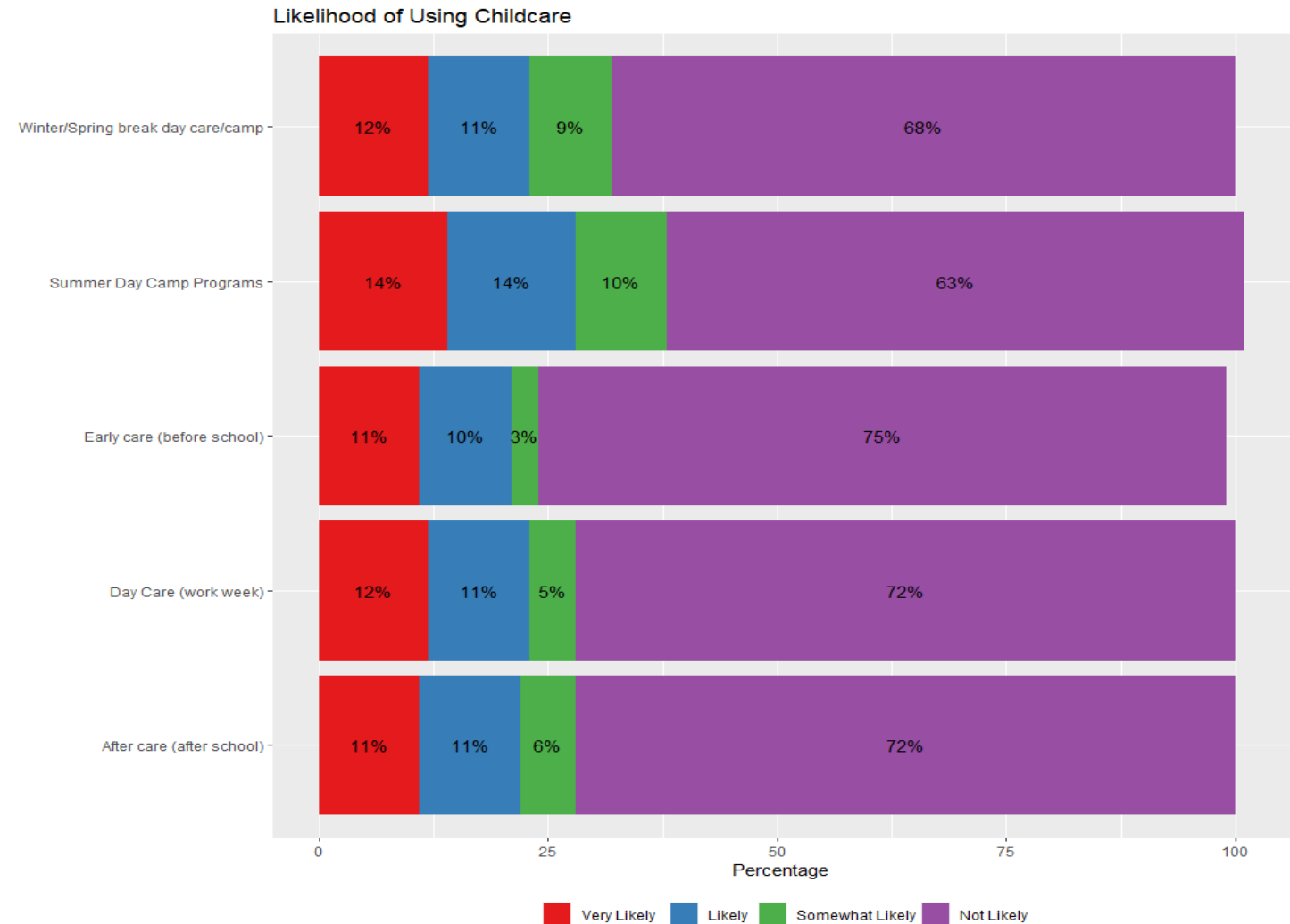
Frequency of Shopping in Crete



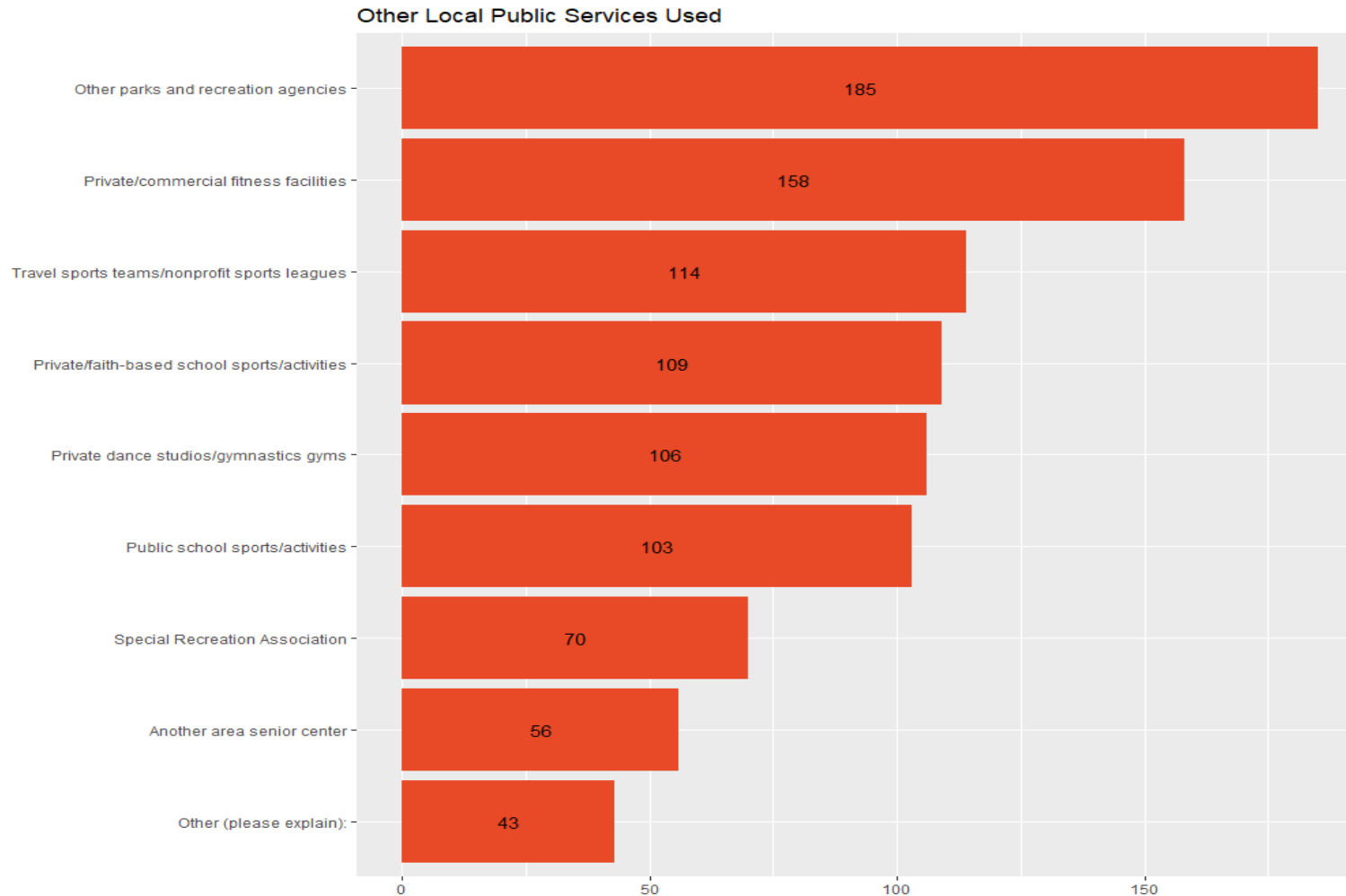
- Grocery shopping was the most common type of shopping in Crete
- Restaurants, banking, and other shopping (non-grocery) were the next most common types of shopping in Crete
- Respondents rarely utilize health services in Crete
- Auto repair and other services also did not often happen in Crete

Utilization of Child Care/Day Camps & Likelihood of Using Them

- Nearly three quarters (74%) of respondents did not currently use childcare offered in Crete
- Summer day camps would be the most likely to be used
 - Winter/spring break day care second most likely

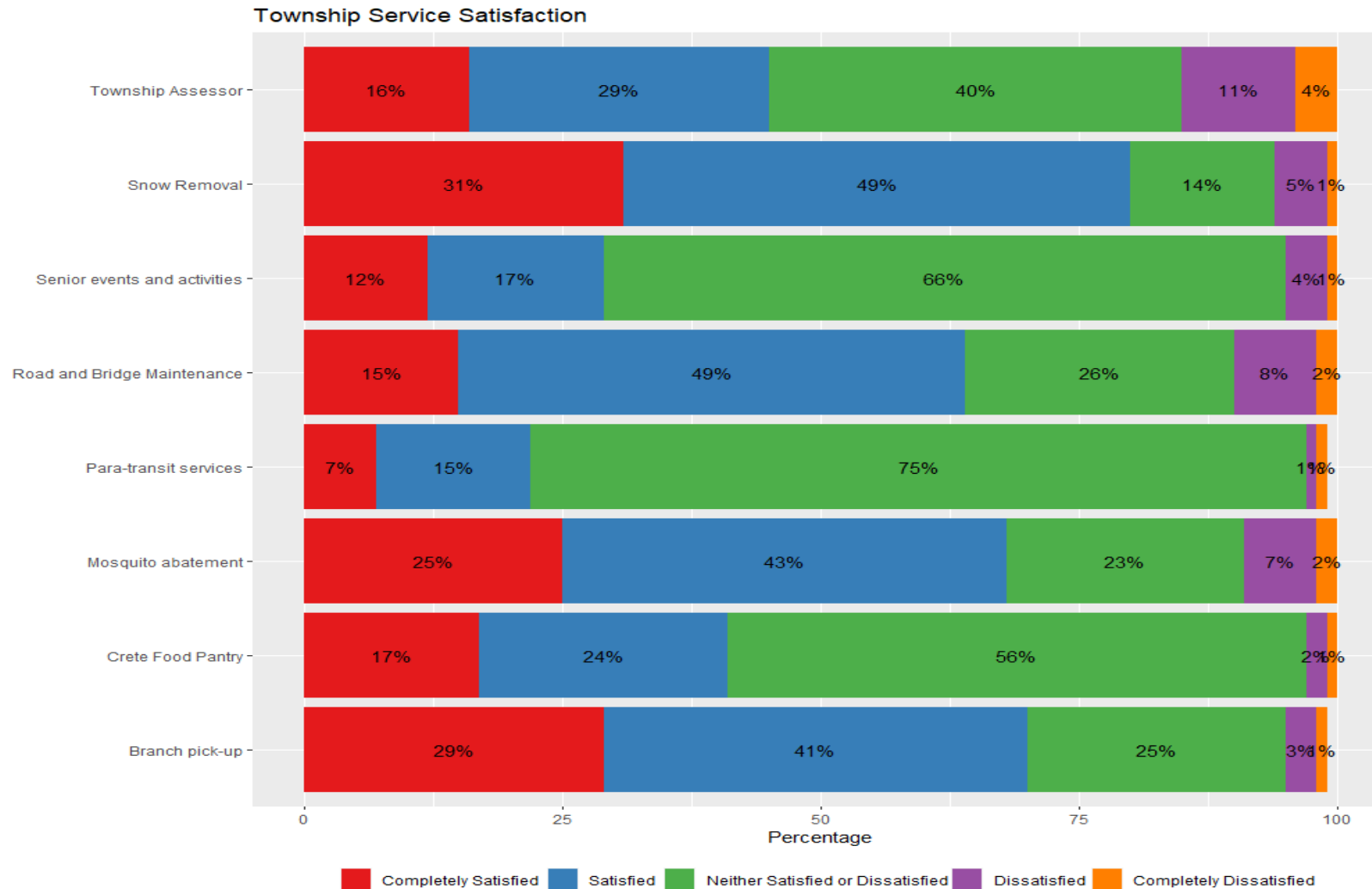


Use of Other Local Public Services



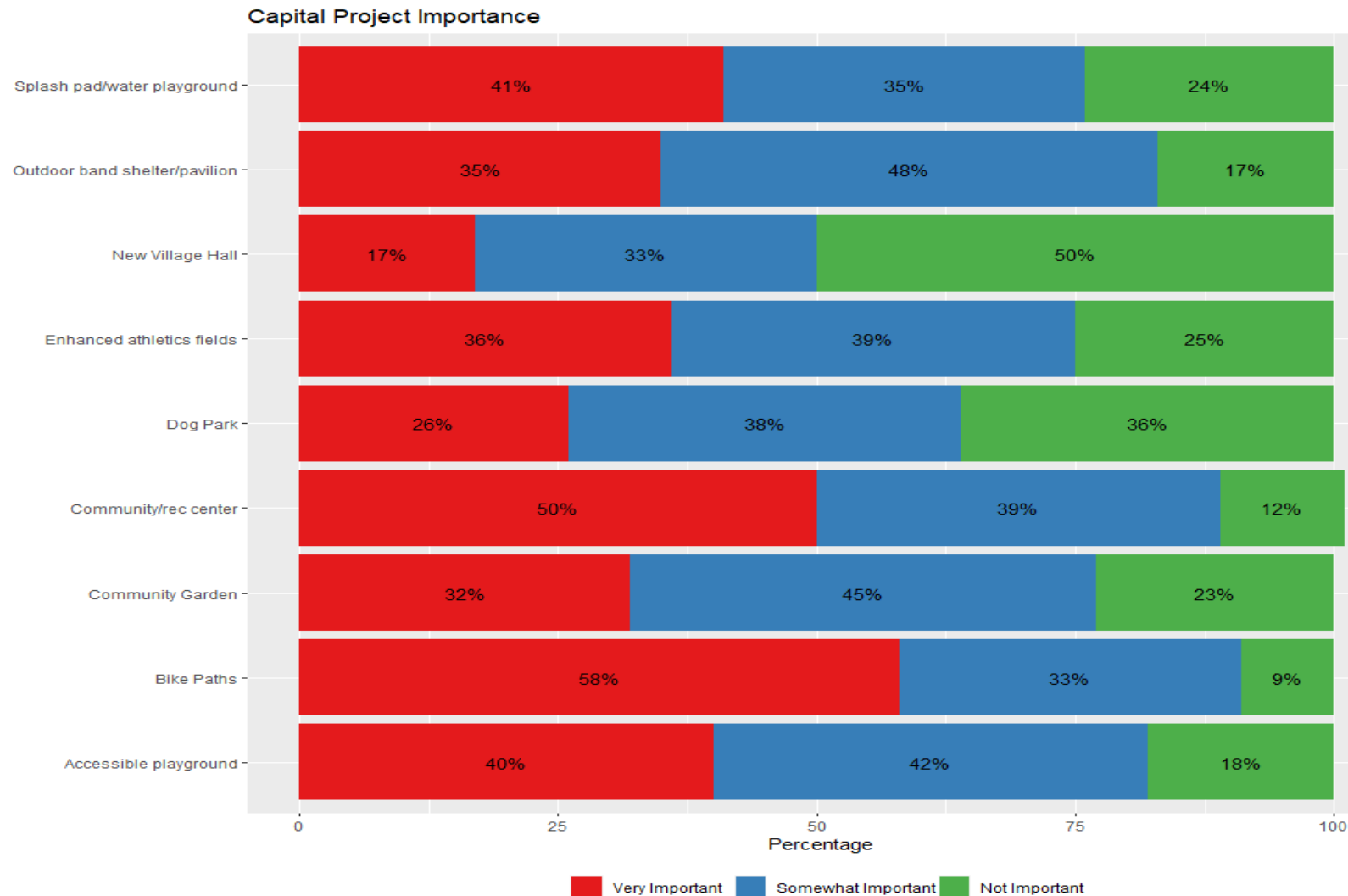
- Other local parks and recreation agencies are the most used local service
- Private fitness facilities and travel sports are the next most popular local services
- Then private faith-based and private dance/gymnastics studios

Satisfaction with Township Services



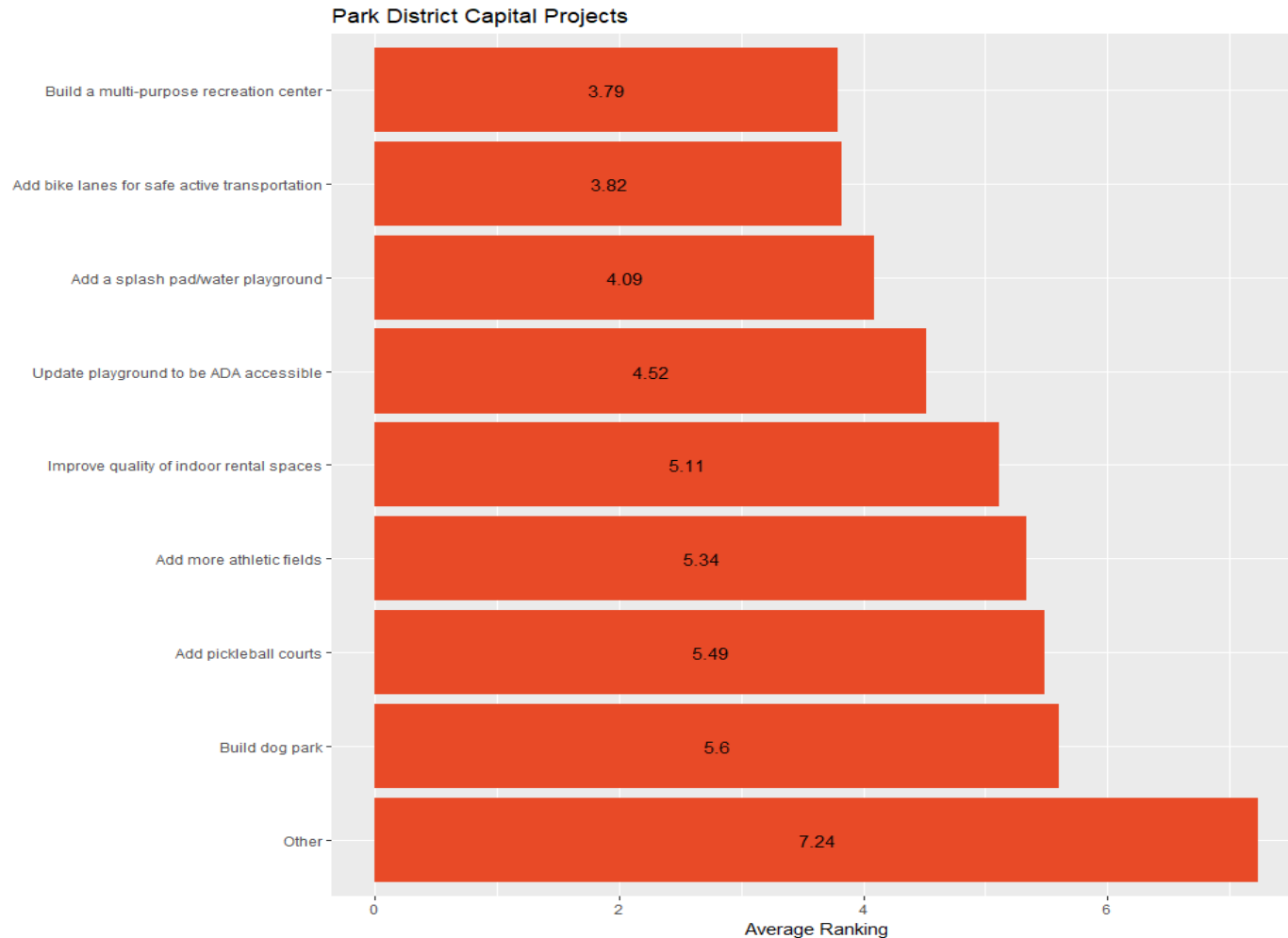
- Residents were generally satisfied by the services provided by the township
- Snow removal and branch pick-up were the most highly rated services
- Senior events and para-transit services were likely underutilized since most respondents did not have an opinion

Capital Project Importance



- 50% or more of respondents rated both community/recreation center and bike paths as 'very important'
- Residents were also interested in:
 - Splash ad
 - Outdoor band pavilion
 - Accessible playgrounds
- Respondents viewed a new Village Hall as the least important initiative

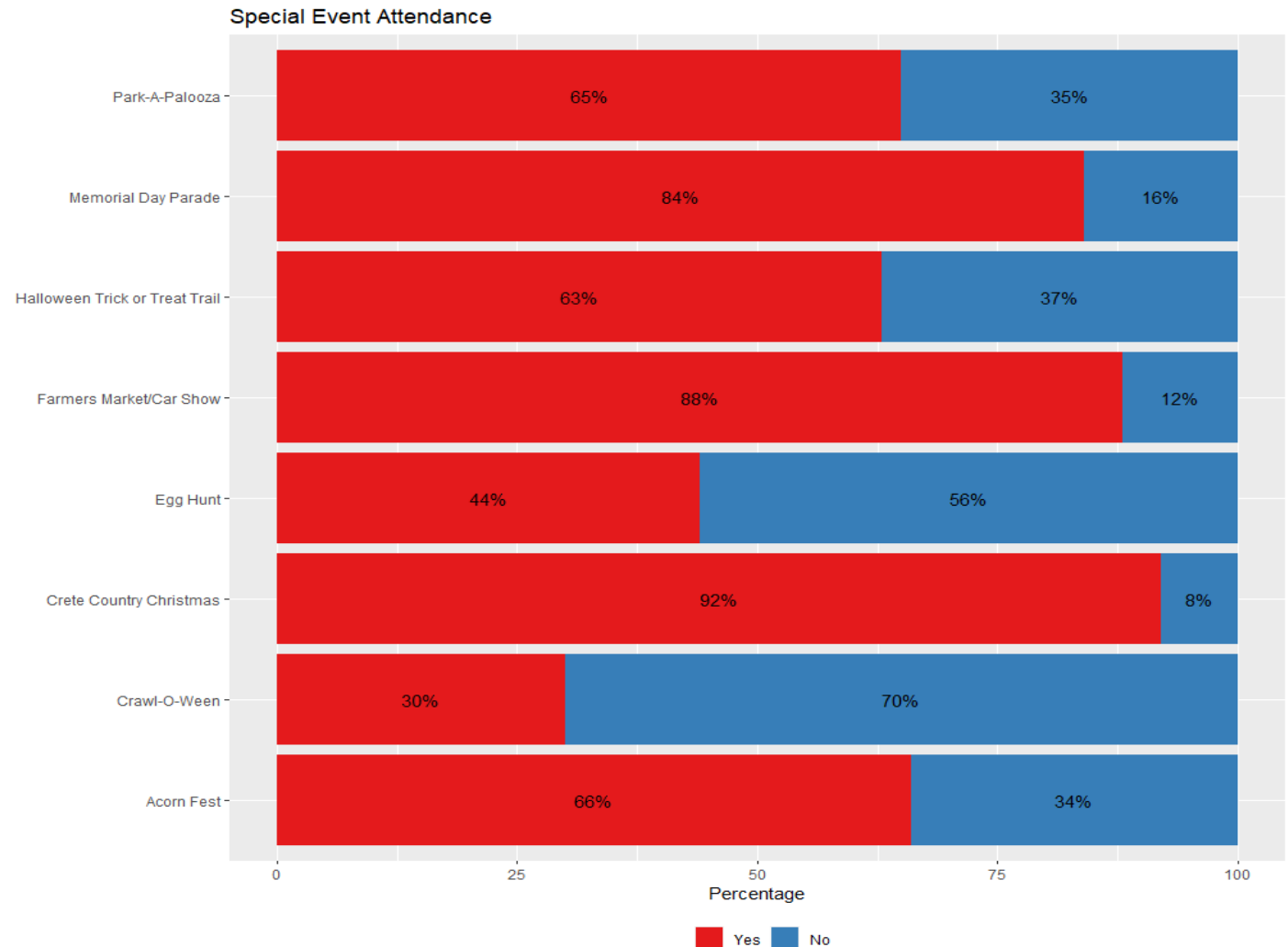
Ranked Park District Capital Projects



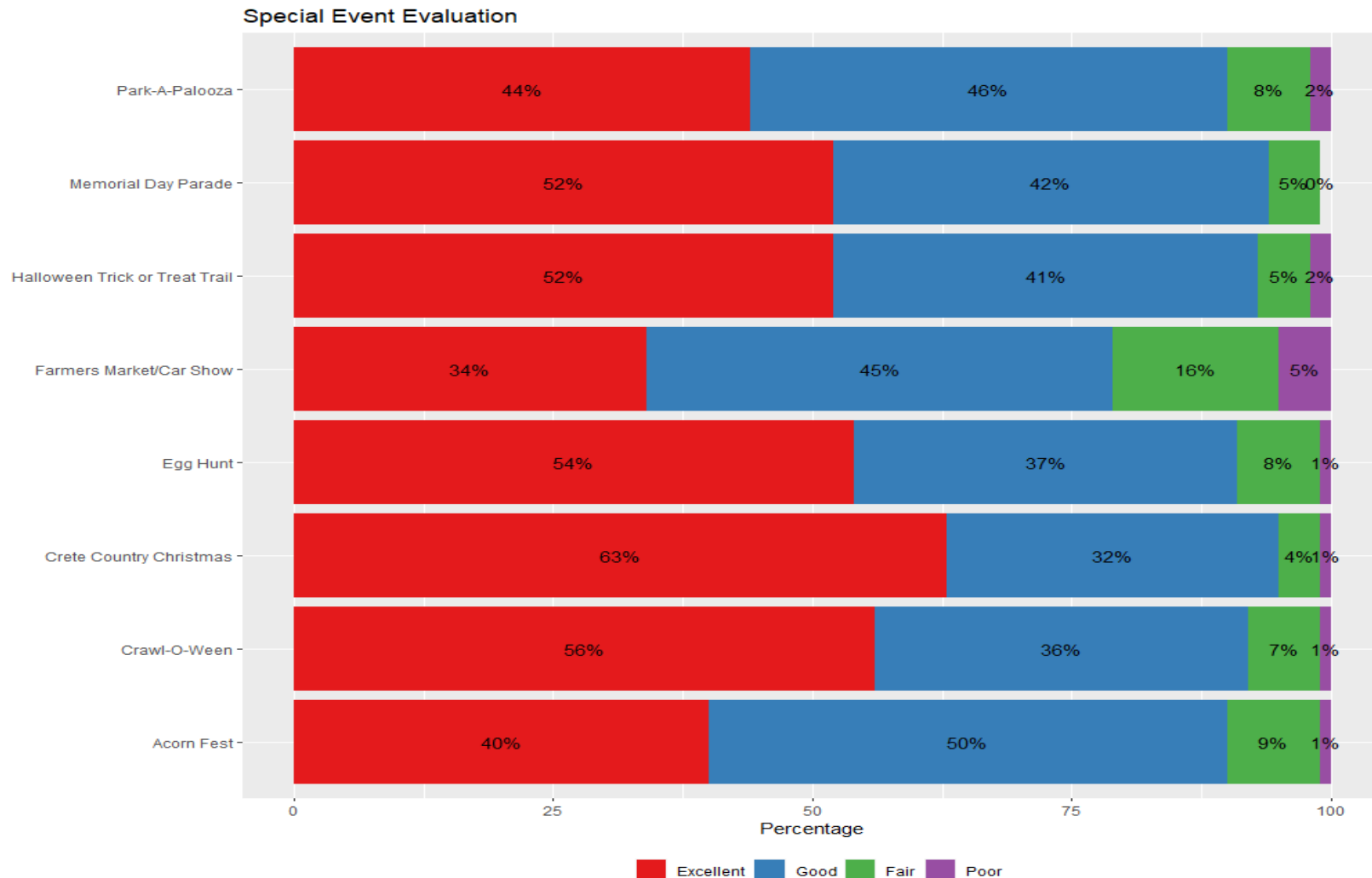
- Building a multi-purpose recreation center was ranked the highest followed closely by:
- Add bike lanes
- Add a splash pad
- Update playgrounds for ADA accessibility
- Build a dog park was rated the lowest

Overall Special Event Attendance

- 70% of respondents (N=350) participated in a special event
- Crete Country Christmas (92%), Farmer's Market/Car Show (88%), and the Memorial Day Parade (84%) were attended the most by respondents
- Crawl O Ween had the lowest participation rate among the special events held in Crete

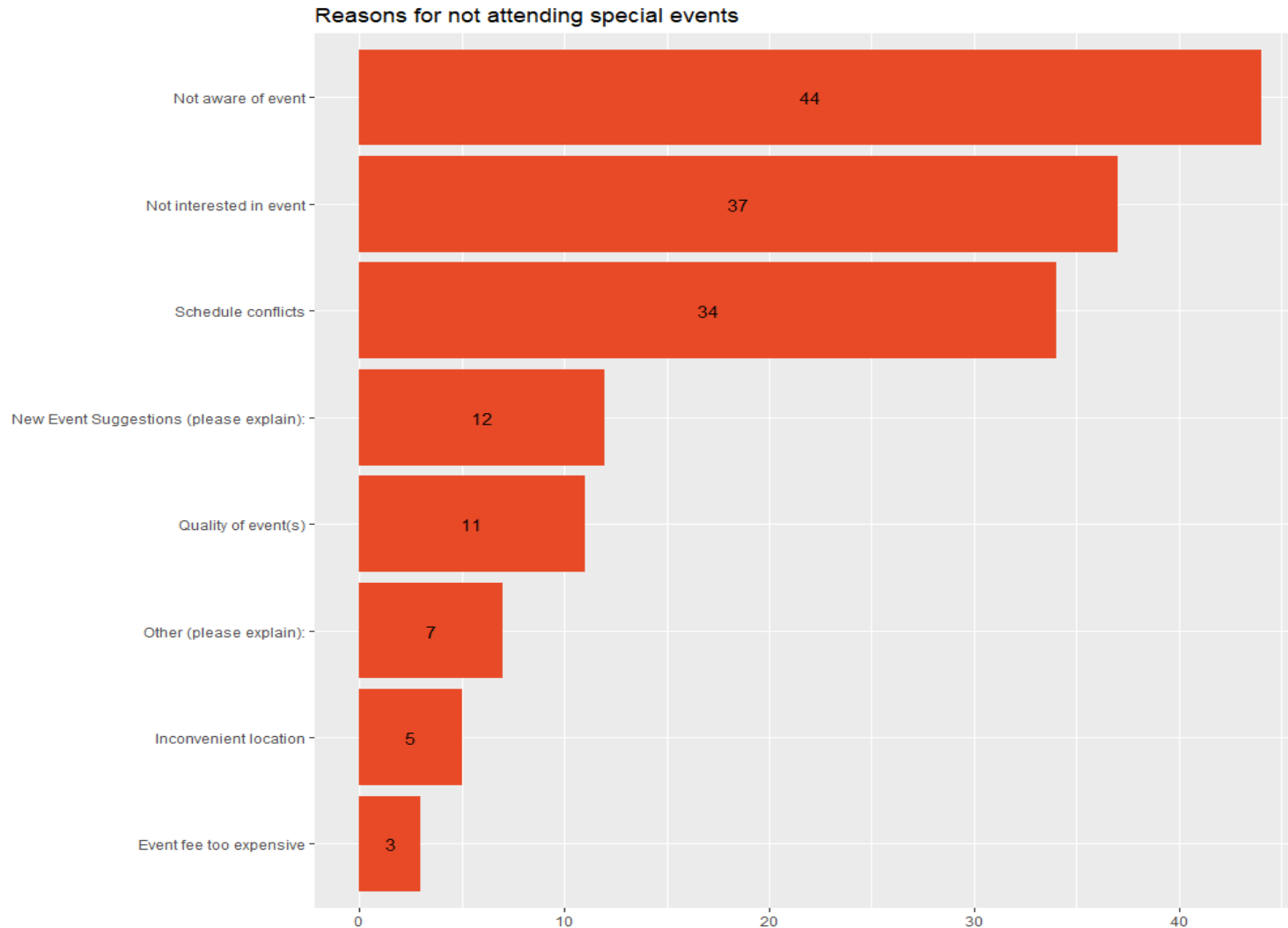


Evaluation of Special Events



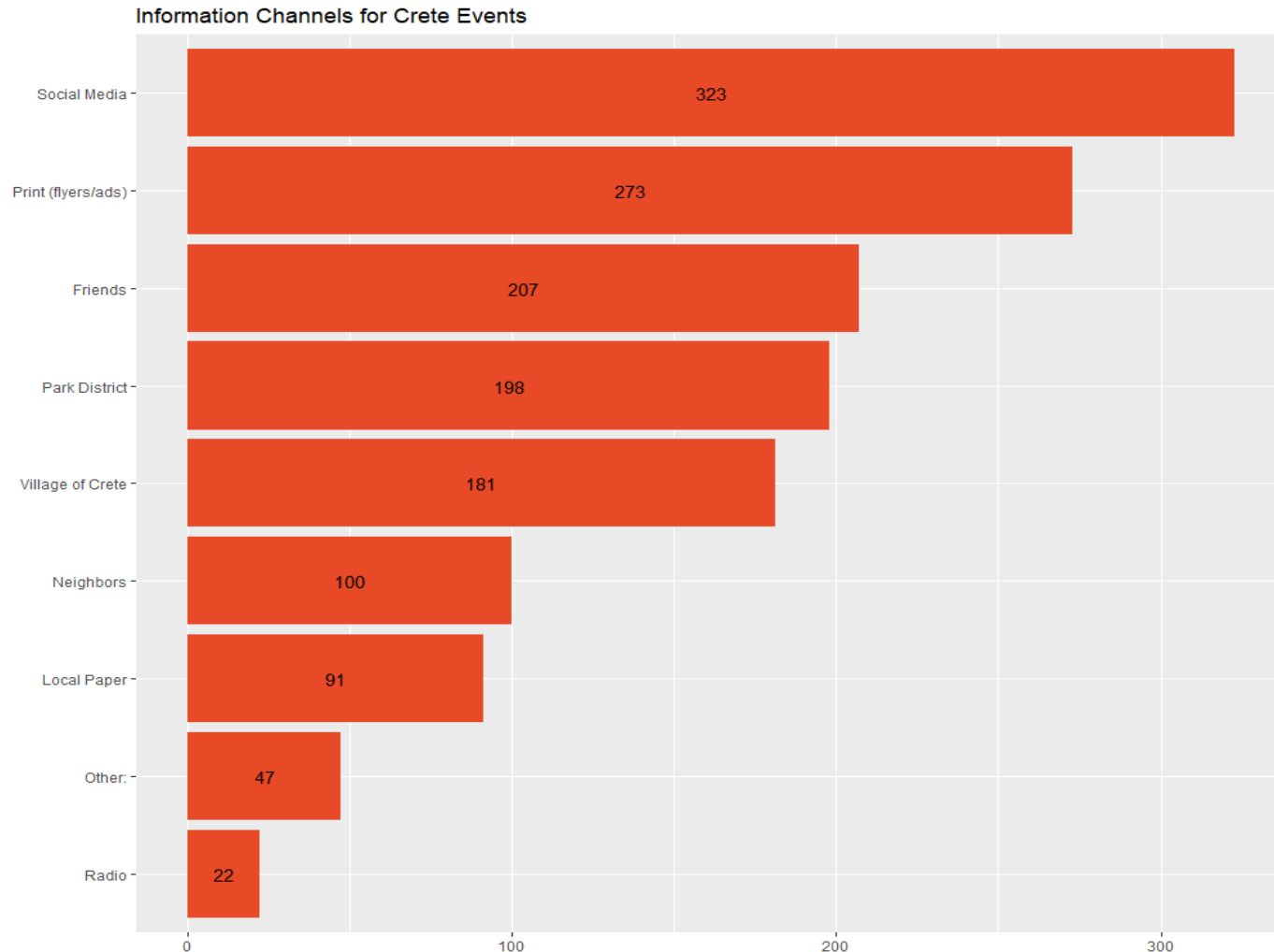
- Over 90% of participants rated Crete Country Christmas as “excellent or good”
- Participants who attended special events were all mainly satisfied

Reasons Residents Do Not Attend Special Events



- The main reason individuals did not participate in attending special events was that they were not aware
- Additionally, individuals were also not interested in special events
- The lowest reason not participating in special events was because the event fee was too expensive

How Residents Hear About Special Events

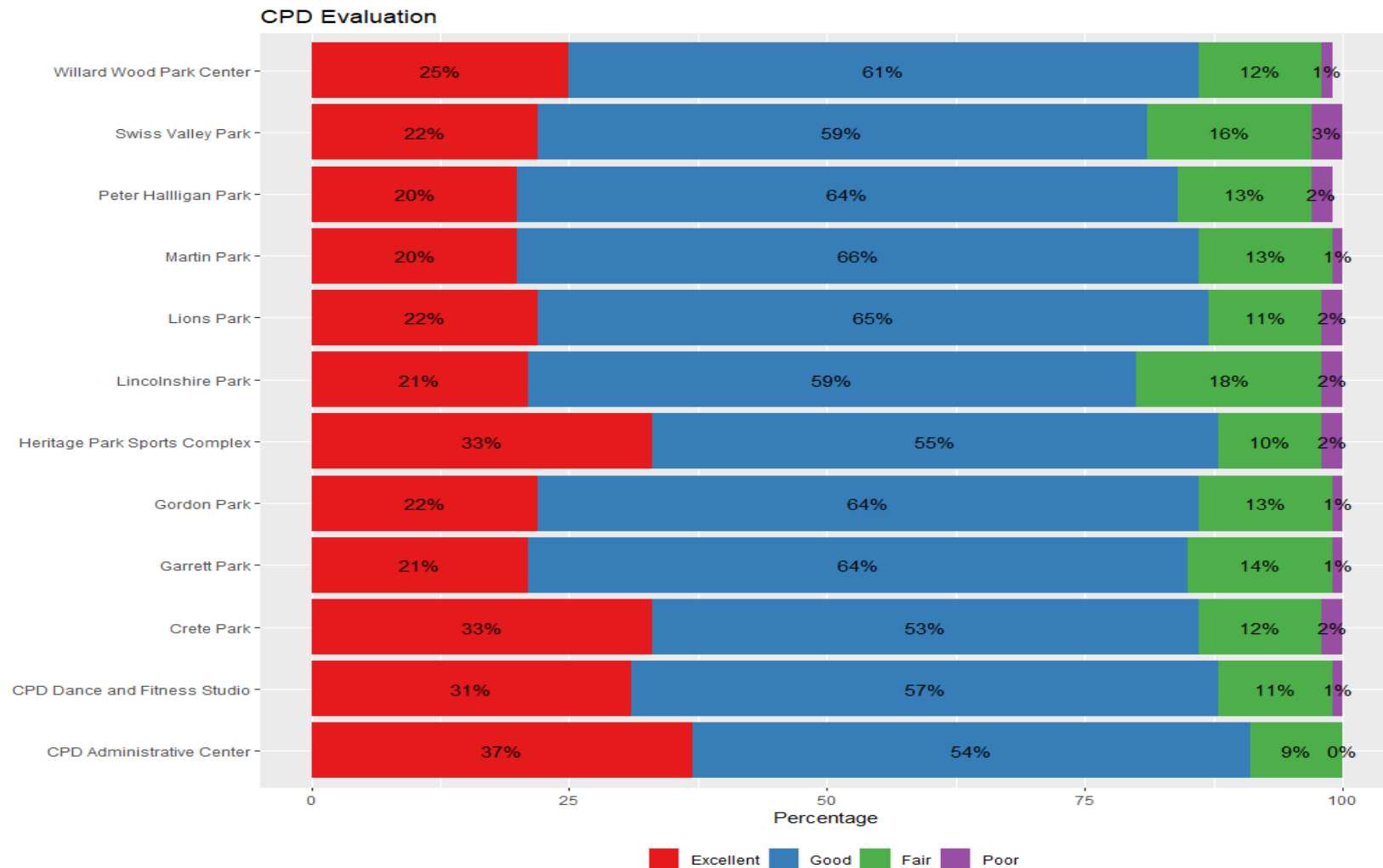


- The most prominent information channels for Crete events were:
- Social media
- Print
- Word of mouth through friends



Parks and Recreation Questions

Evaluation of Parks and Recreation Facilities



- All of the Parks and Recreation facilities in Crete were rated favorably
- The CPD Administrative center showed the highest satisfactory rate
- Two parks to focus on = Lincolnshire Park - 20% rated it as "fair or poor" and Swiss Valley Park – 19% rated it "fair or poor"

Insights about Parks and Recreation Facilities

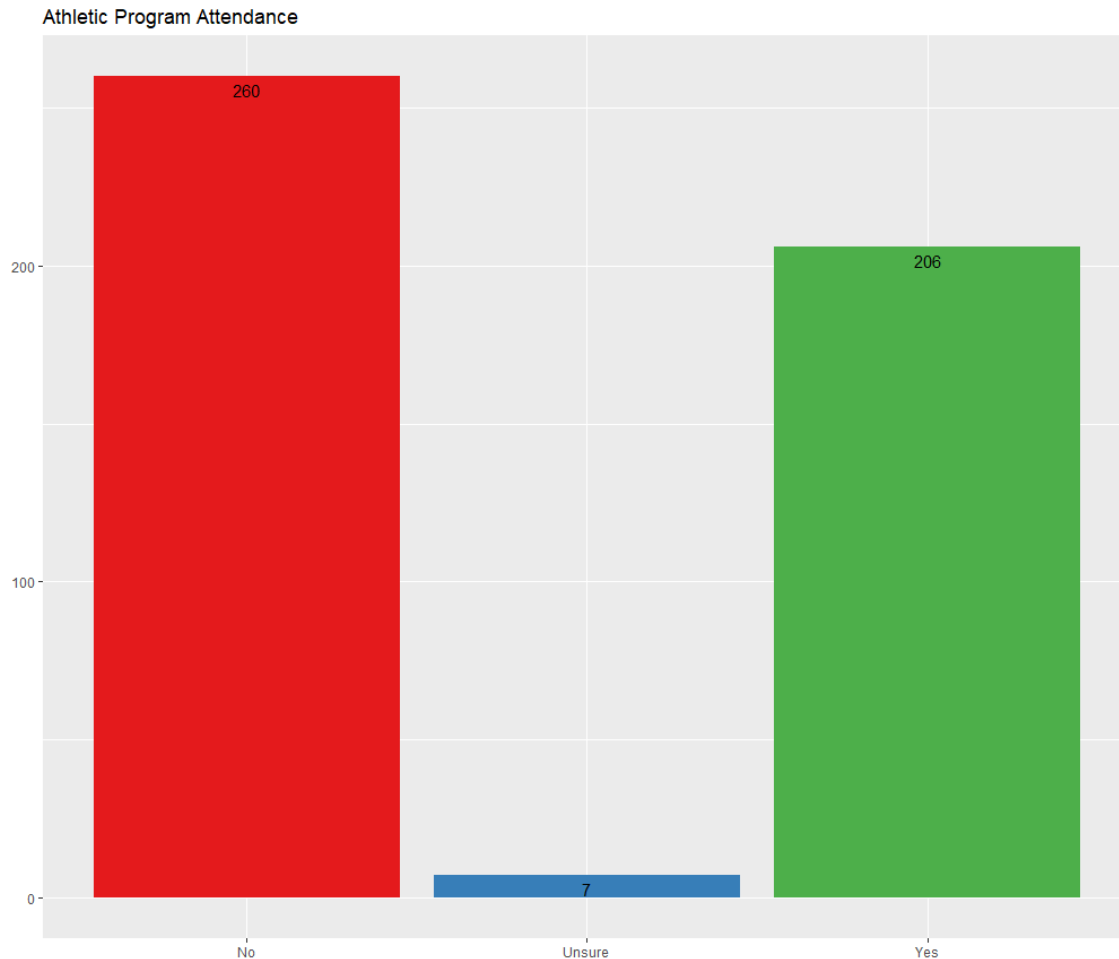
Equipment and Facilities:

- 31 respondents mentioned playground equipment is outdated and needs replacing at several parks.
- Several suggested more bleachers at Heritage Park
- Several suggested adding more sports fields and basketball courts
- A few people mentioned the public restrooms were locked

Maintenance Needed/Litter:

- Concerns about litter in some parks (Crete Park and Heritage were named)

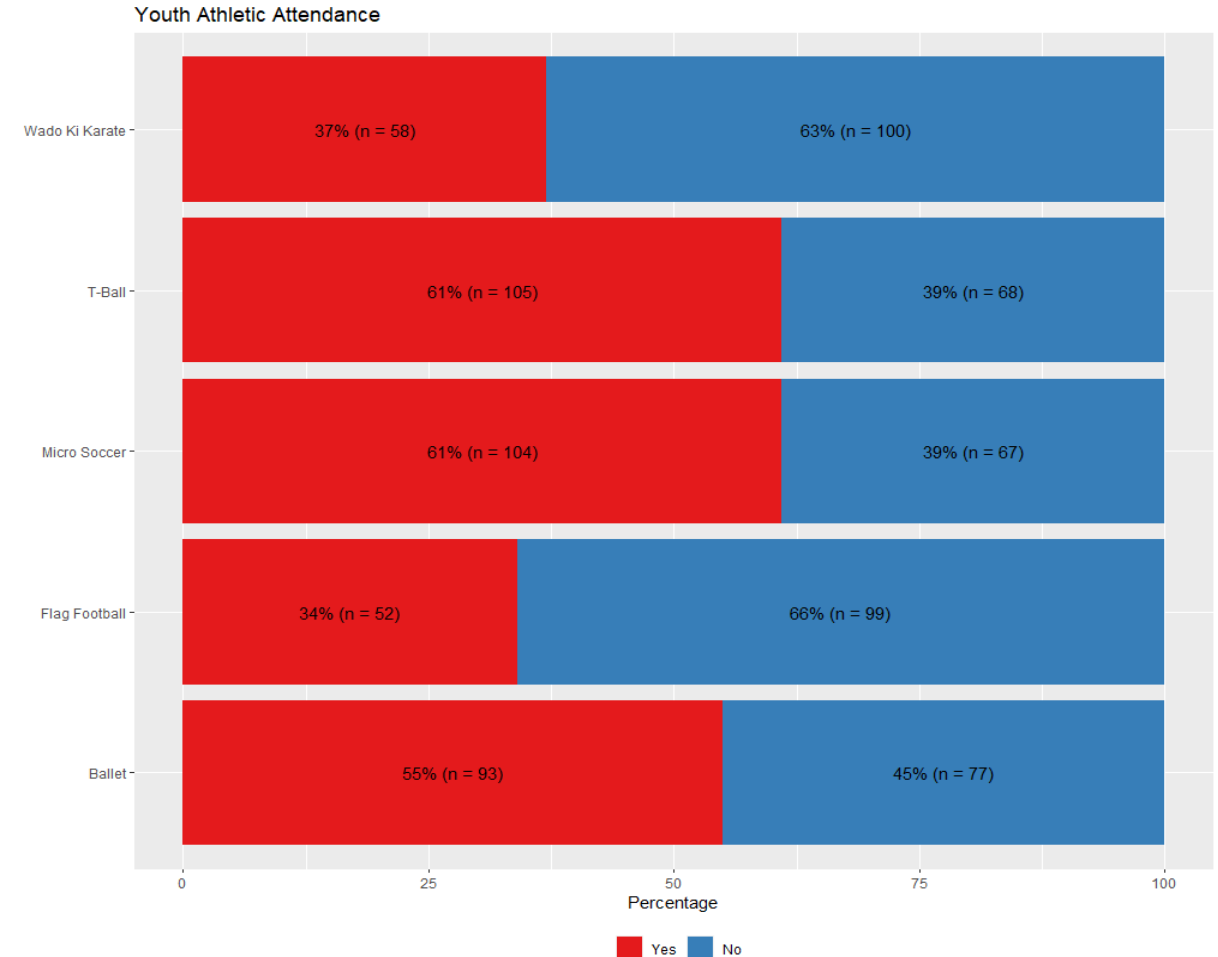
Athletics, Dance & Fitness Program Attendance



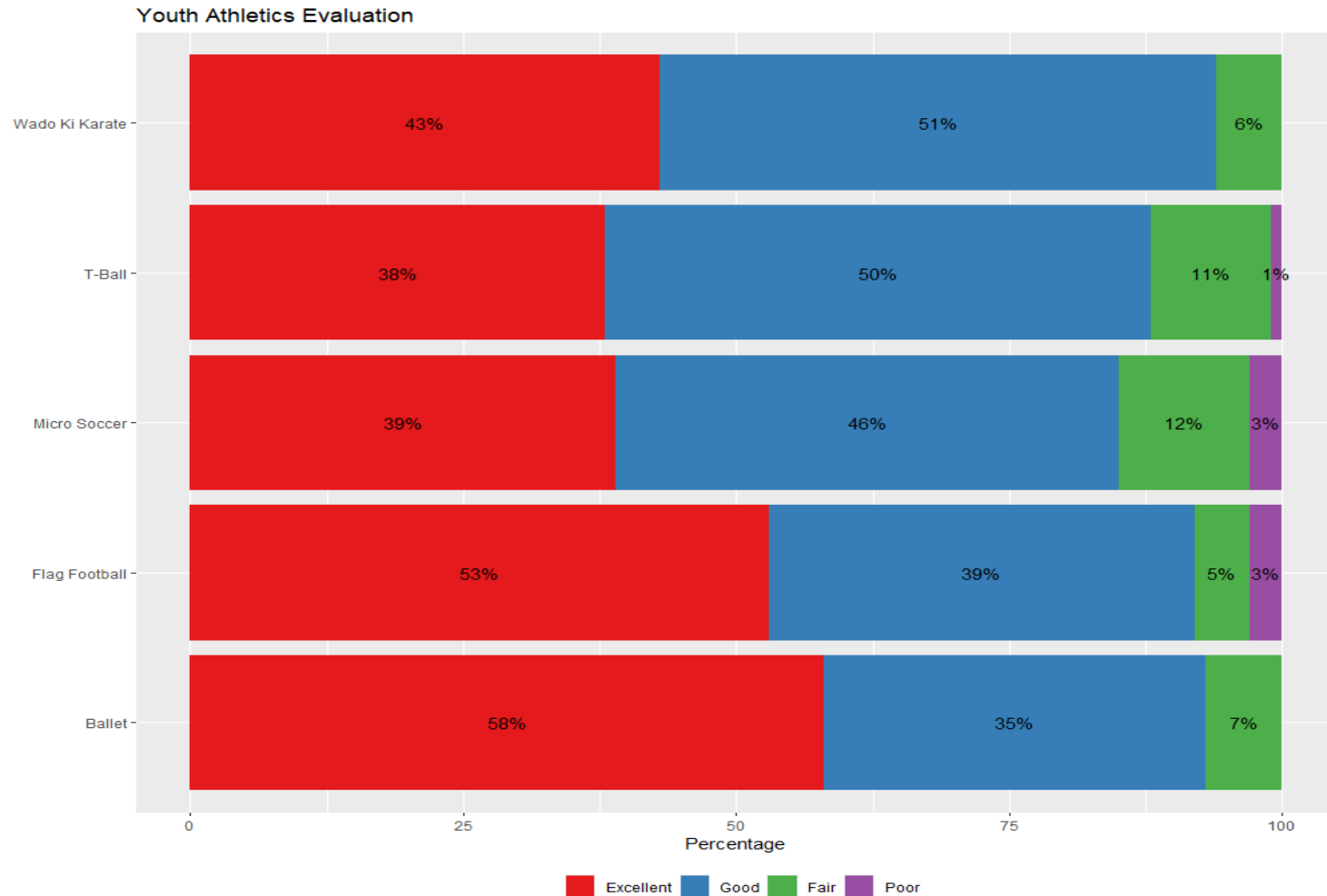
- 43% (N=206) respondents participated in Athletics, Dance, & Fitness programs
- Among 473 respondents, 260 respondents did not participate in Athletics, Dance, & Fitness programs in Crete.

Youth Athletics and Dance Program Attendance

- T-ball and Micro-soccer showed the highest attendance rate (61%) among Youth Athletic, Dance, and Fitness programs
- Flag Football had the lowest attendance rate (34%) among Youth Athletic, Dance, and Fitness programs

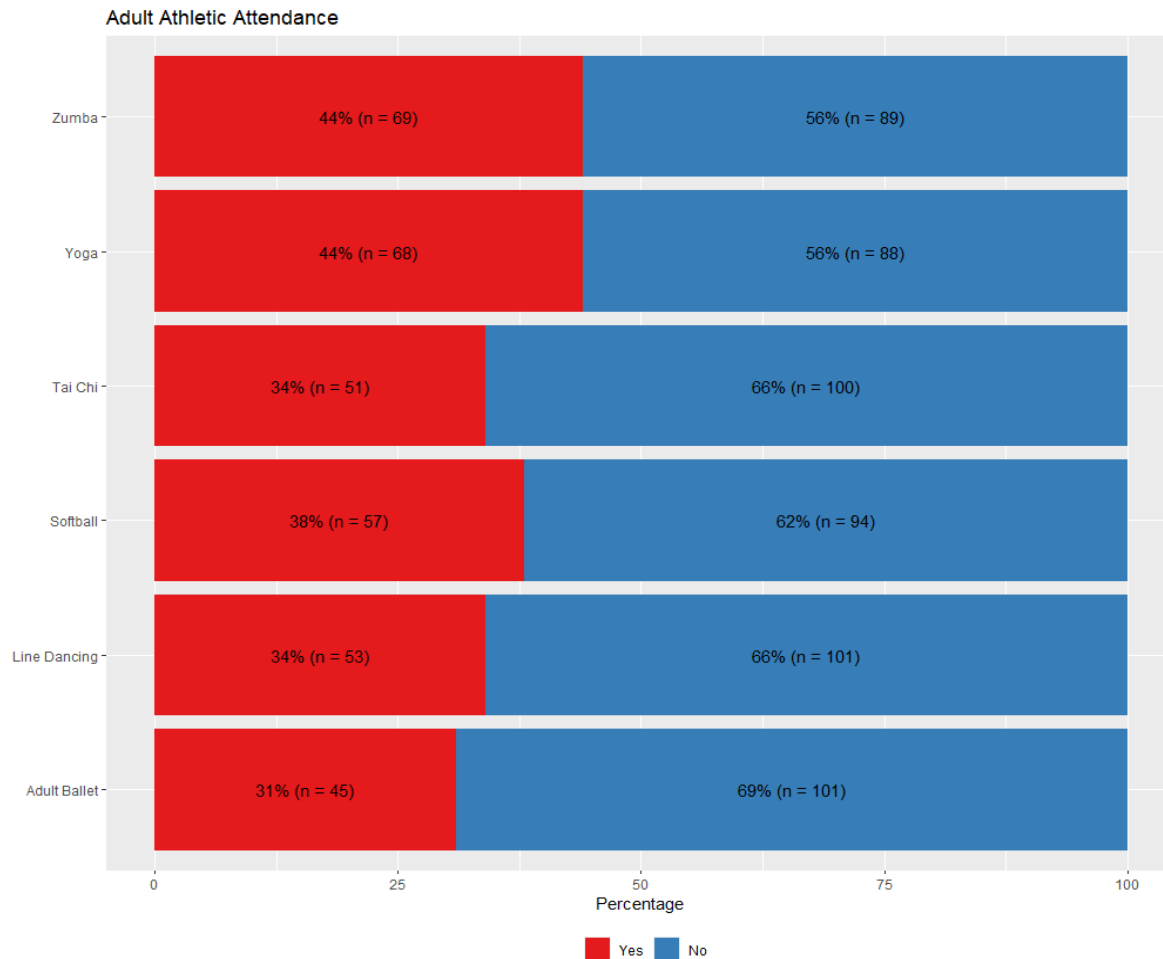


Youth Athletics and Dance Program Evaluation



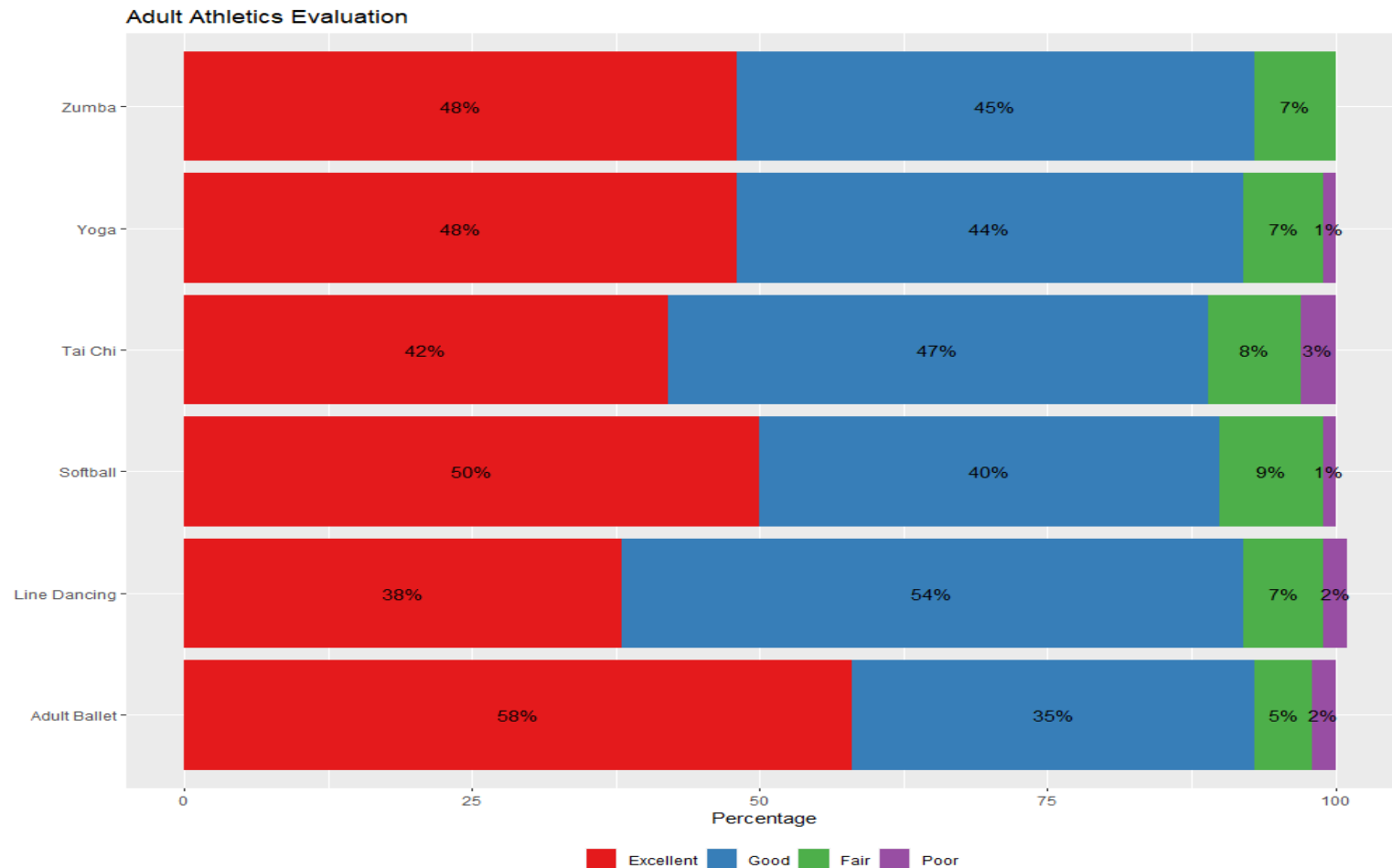
- All of the Youth Athletics and Dance programs in Crete were evaluated as “excellent or good” with few rated as “fair or poor”
- Ballet and Karate had the highest favorable evaluation among the Youth Athletic and Dance programs

Adult Athletics, Dance, & Fitness Program Attendance



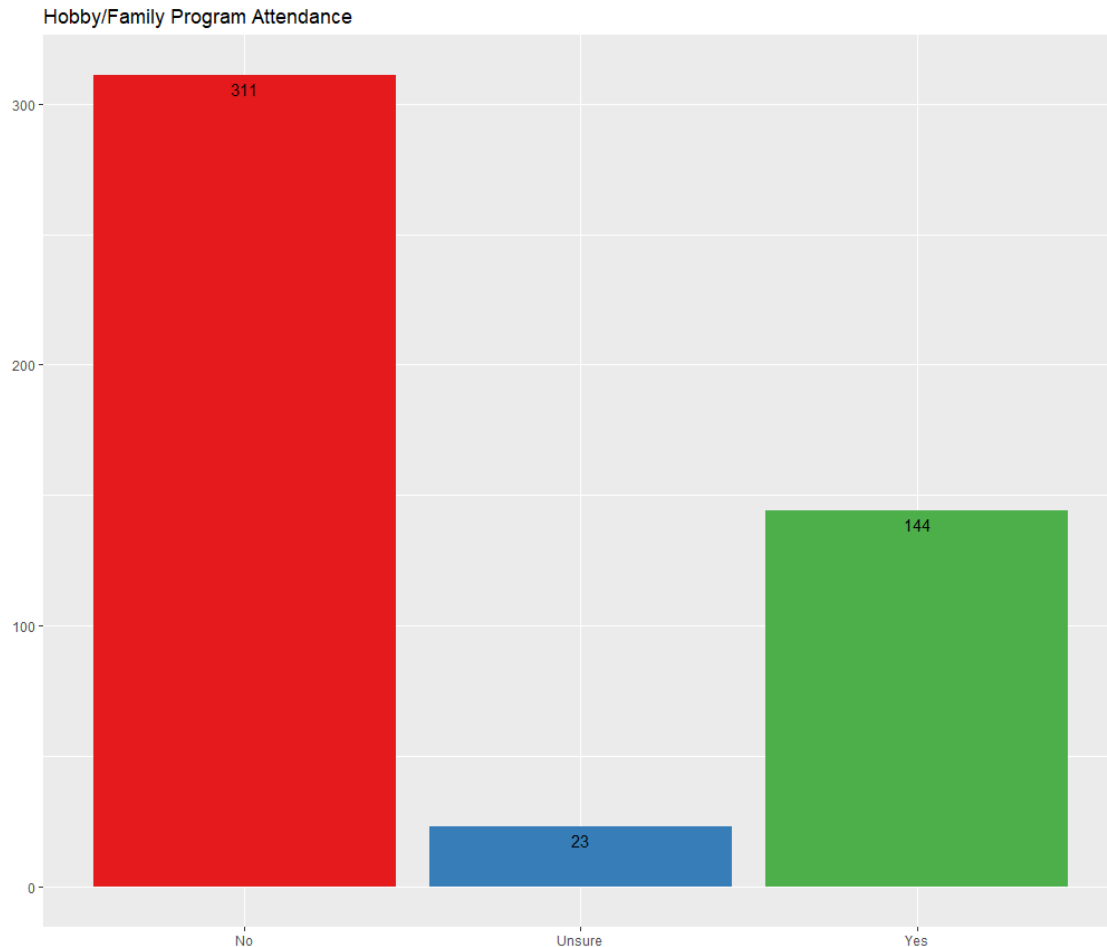
- Zumba and Yoga had the highest attendance rate (44%) among Adult Athletics, Dance, & Fitness programs.
- Adult Ballet had the lowest attendance rate (31%) among the Adult Athletics, Dance, & Fitness programs.

Adult Athletics, Dance, and Fitness Program Evaluation



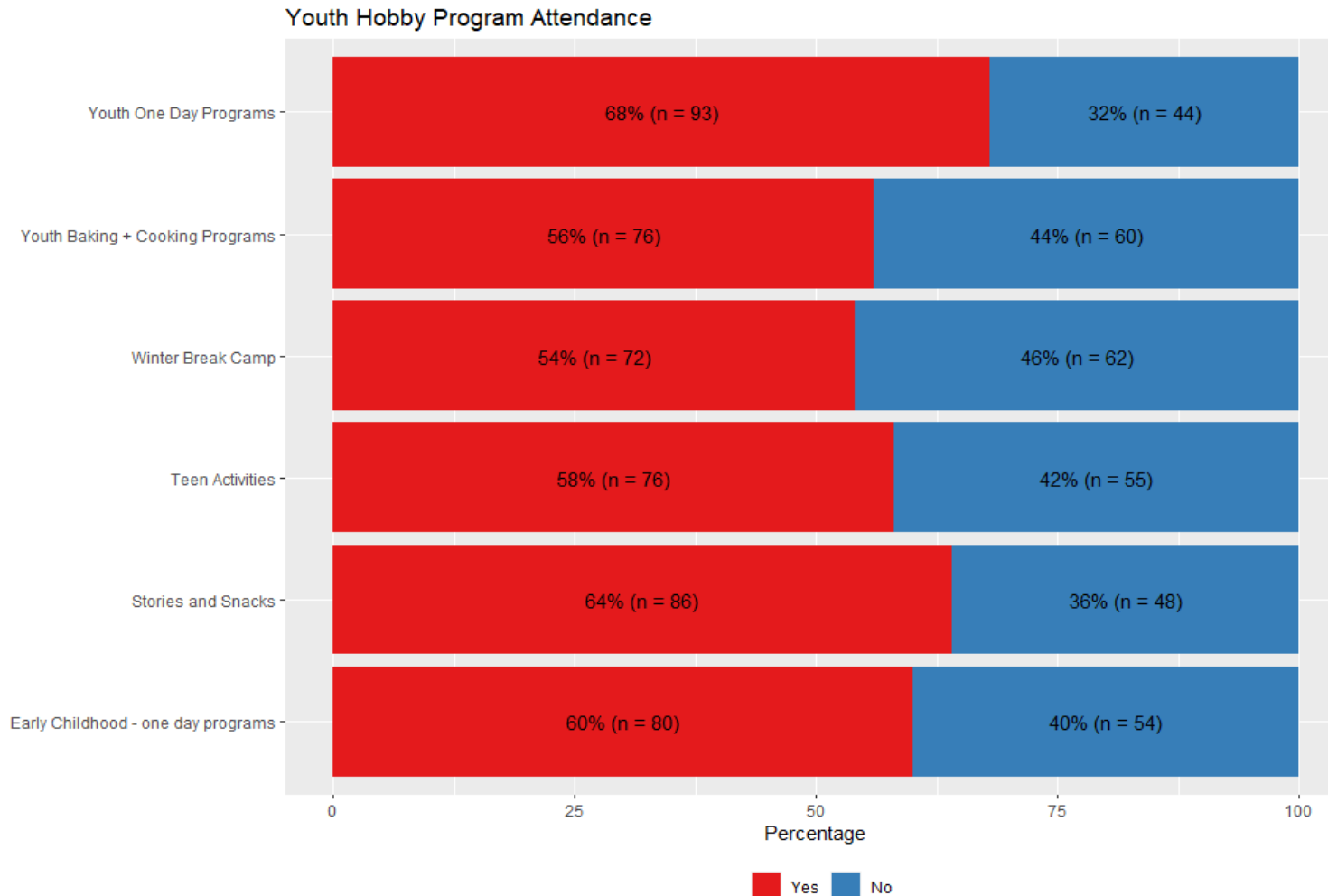
- All of the adult athletics, dance, and fitness programs in Crete were favorably evaluated.
- Adult Ballet showed the highest positive rate among adult athletics, dance, and fitness programs in Crete.

Hobby Program Attendance



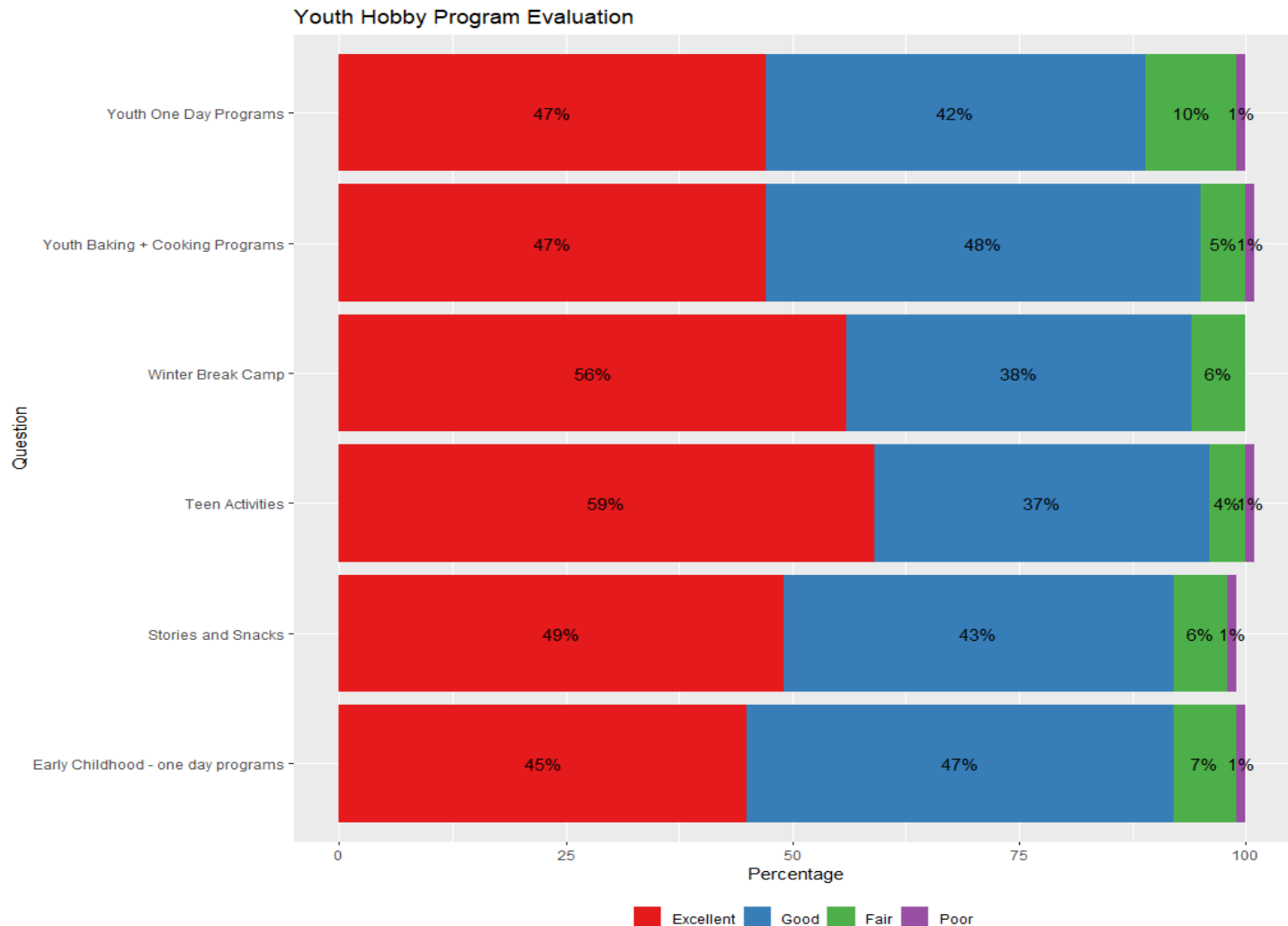
- Among 478 respondents, 65% (N=311) respondents reported that they participated in Hobby programs
- 30% (N=144) respondents reported that they have not participated in Hobby programs

Youth Hobby Program Attendance



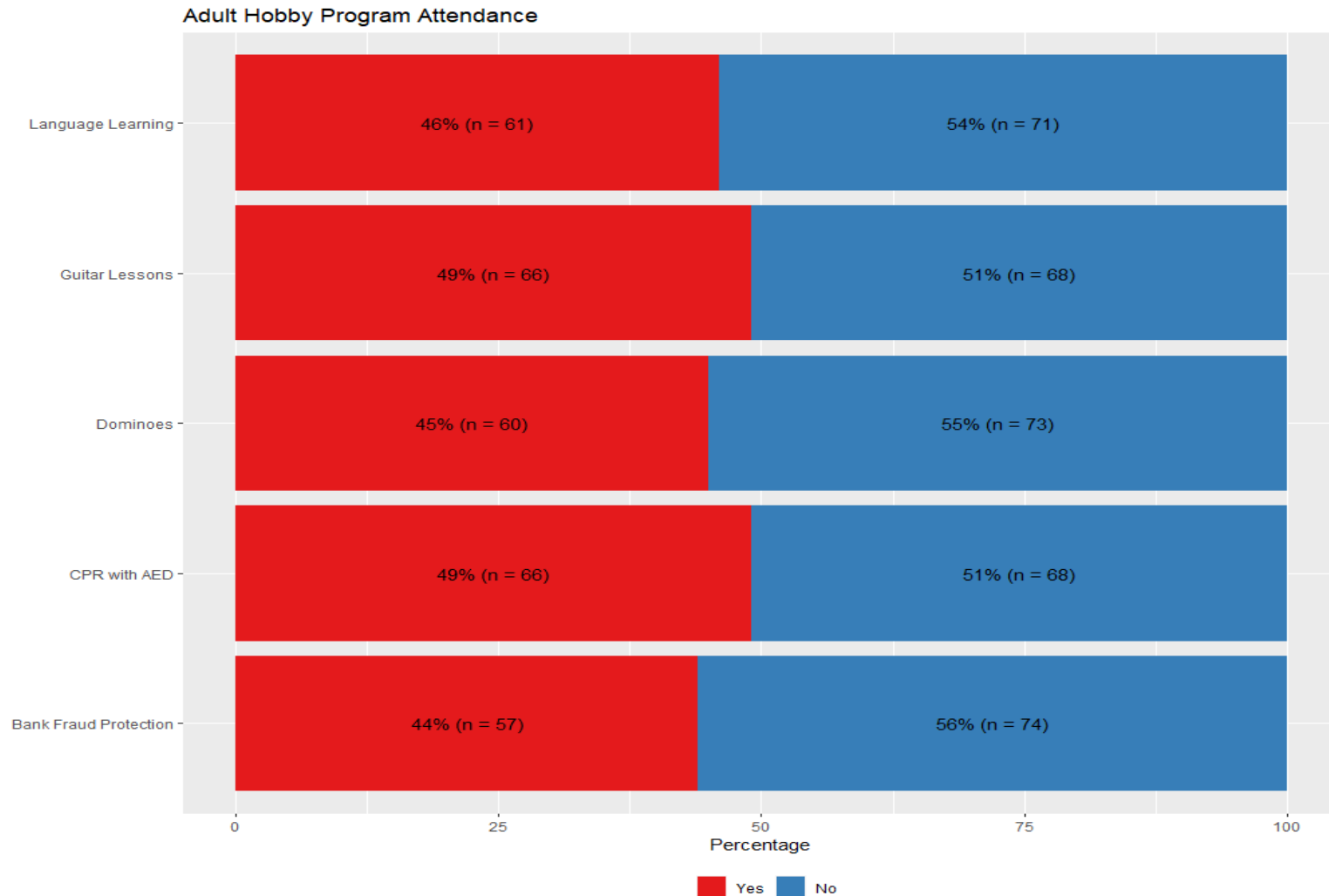
- Youth One Day programs had the highest attendance rate (68%) among the youth hobby programs
- Winter Break Camp showed the lowest attendance rate (54%) among the youth hobby programs in Crete.
 - 54% is still fairly high!

Youth Hobby Program Evaluation



- All of the Youth Hobby programs were favorably rated
- In particular Teen Activities were highly rated with almost 100% who rated them "excellent or good"
- All programs were highly rated

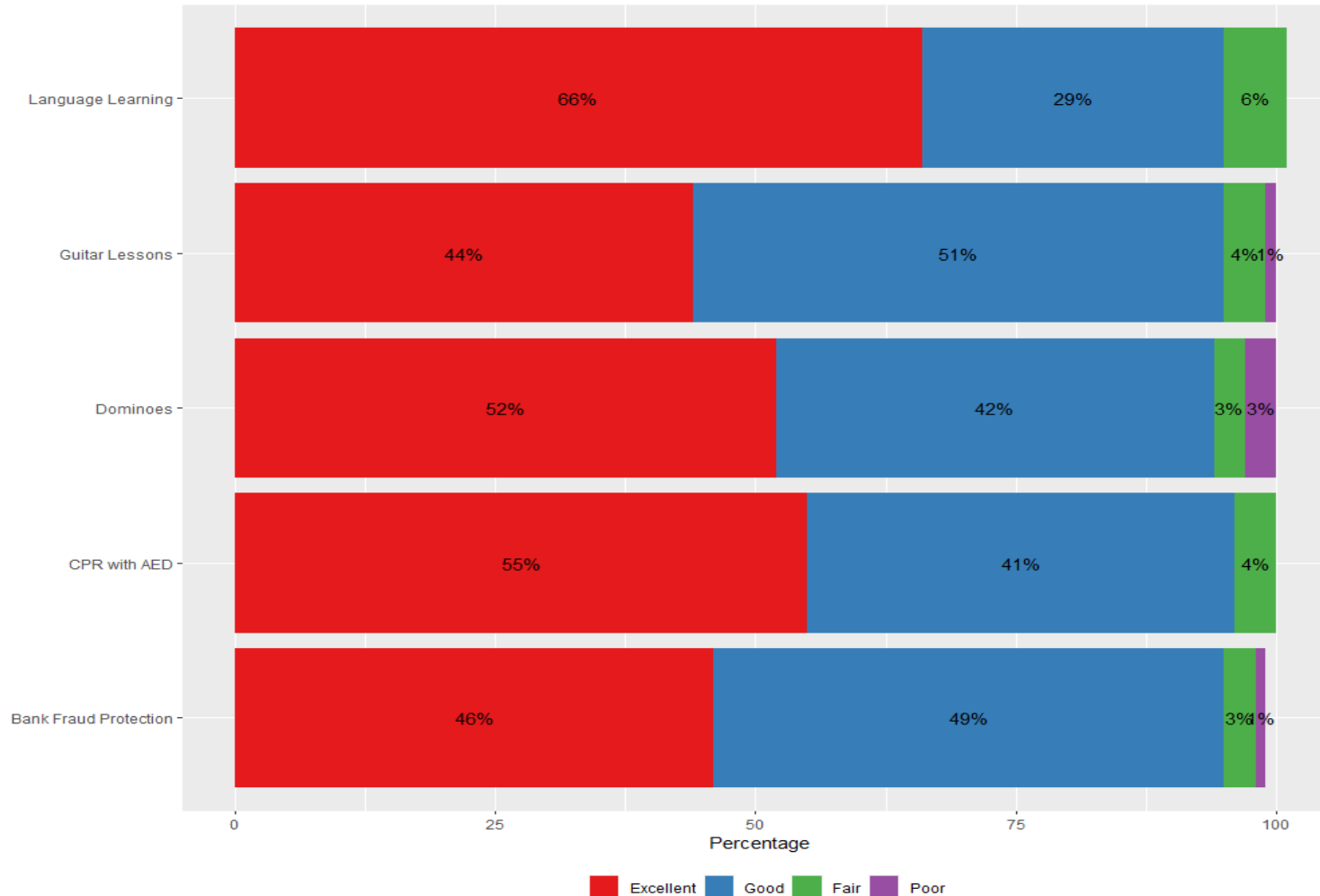
Adult Hobby Program Attendance



- Guitar lessons and CPR with AED showed the highest attendance rate (49%) among Adult Hobby programs
- Bank Fraud Protection showed the lowest attendance rate (44%) among Adult Hobby programs

Adult Hobby Program Evaluation

Adult and Family Program Evaluation



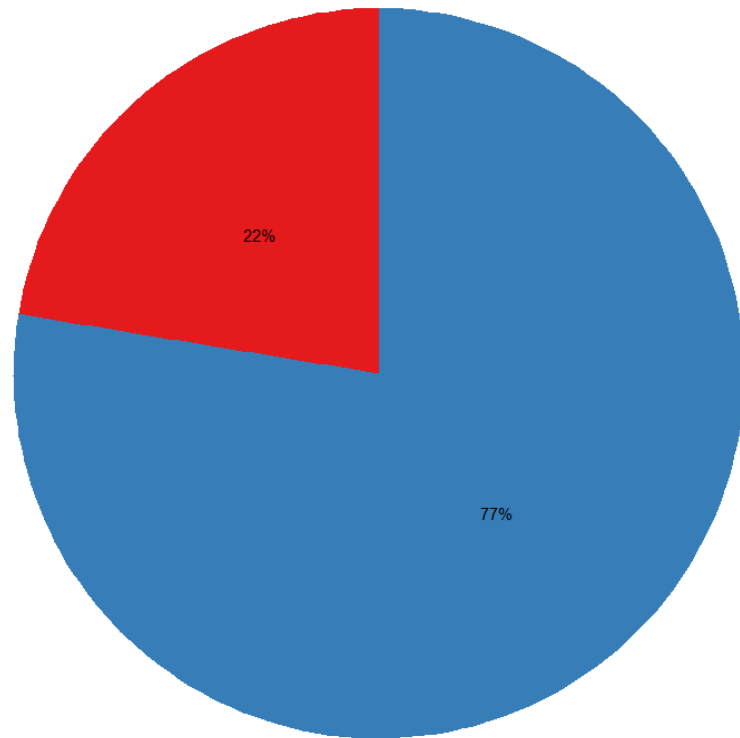
- All of the Adult Hobby programs reported highly positive evaluations – over 90% evaluated these programs as “excellent or good”
- Language learning showed the highest satisfactory rate 95% who rated it as “excellent or good”



Library Questions

Possession of Library Card

Library Card

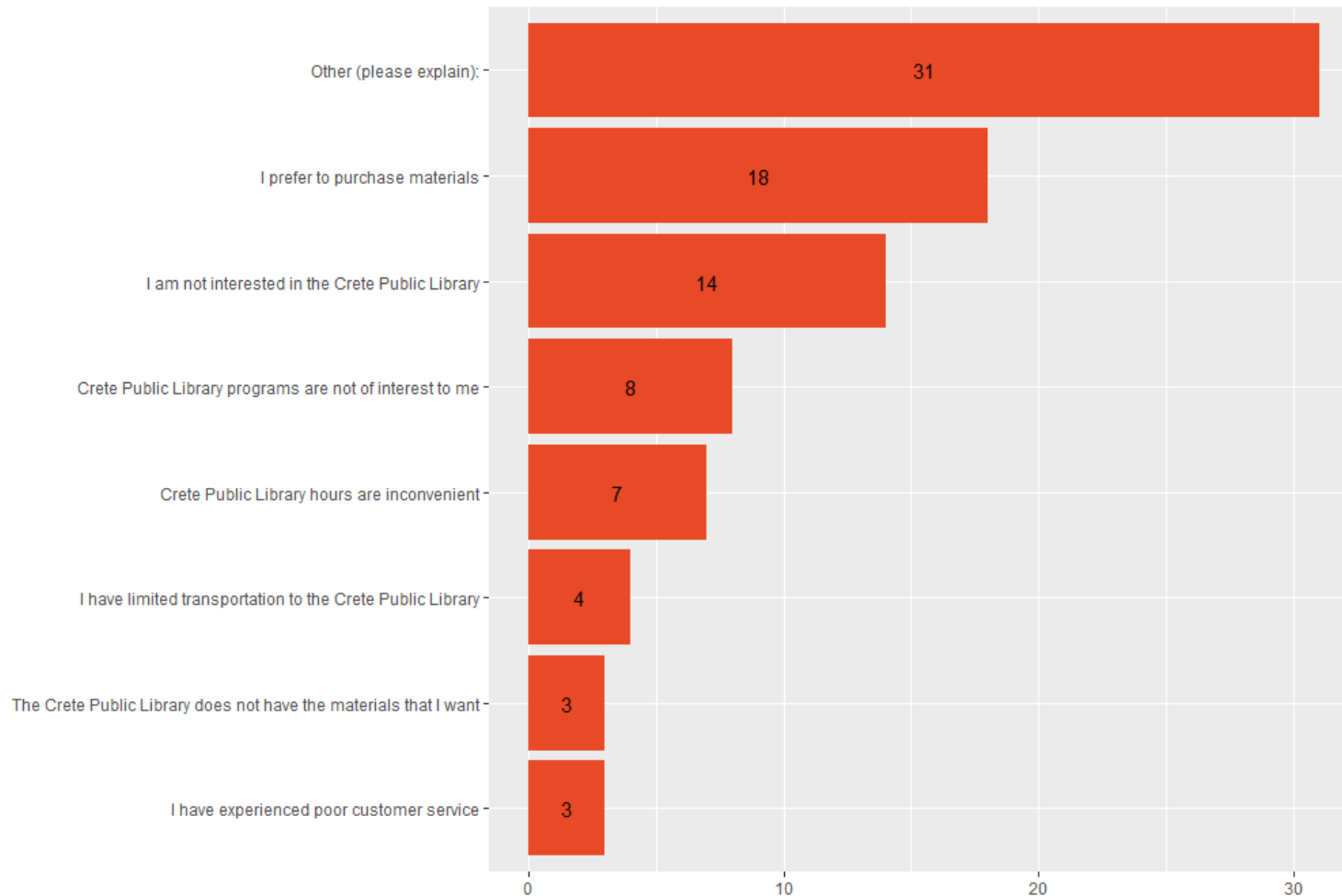


■ No ■ Yes

- 77% of respondents reported that they have a library card
- 22% do not have a library card

Reasons for Not Having a Library Card

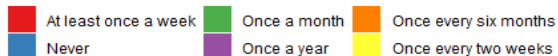
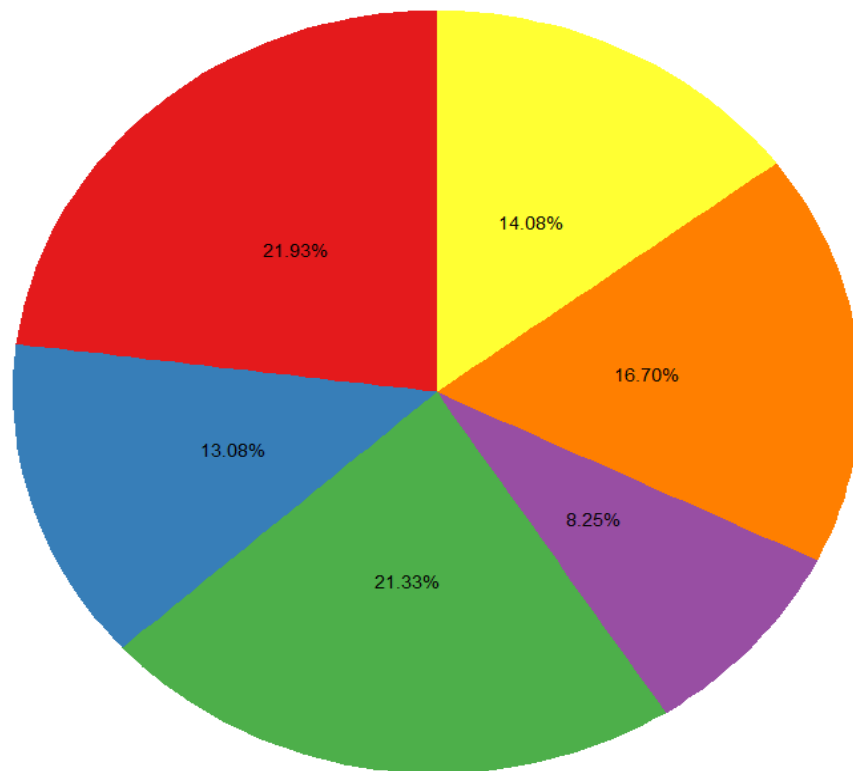
No library card



- The most frequent reason for not having a library card was “other” – which included not interested and not enough time, being an e-book reader, “haven’t gotten around to it” and “intend to get a library card”
- 18 respondents prefer to purchase materials
- The lowest reasons for not having a library card were individuals experienced poor customer service and the library not having the wanted materials (n=3)

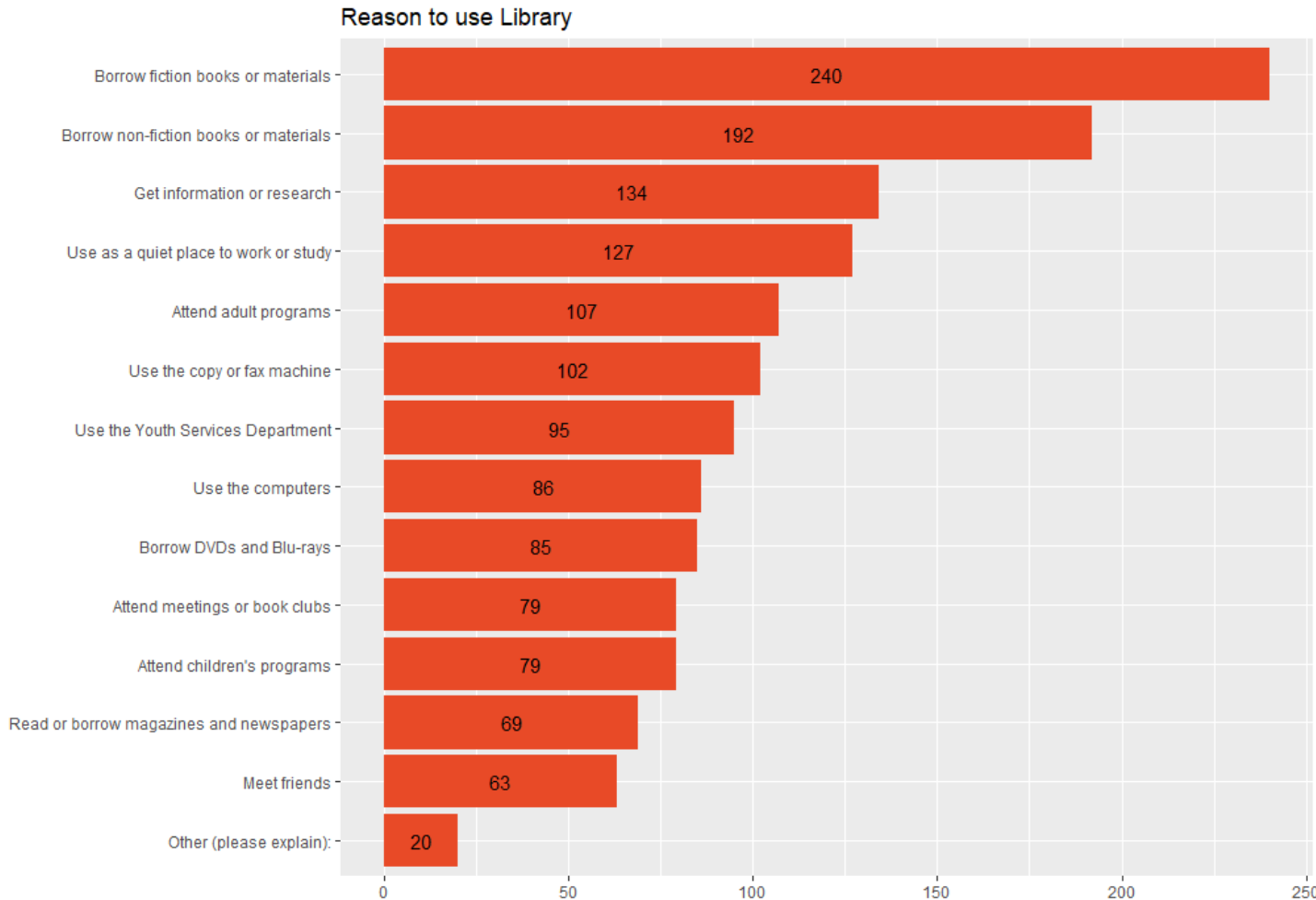
Library Usage

Library Usage



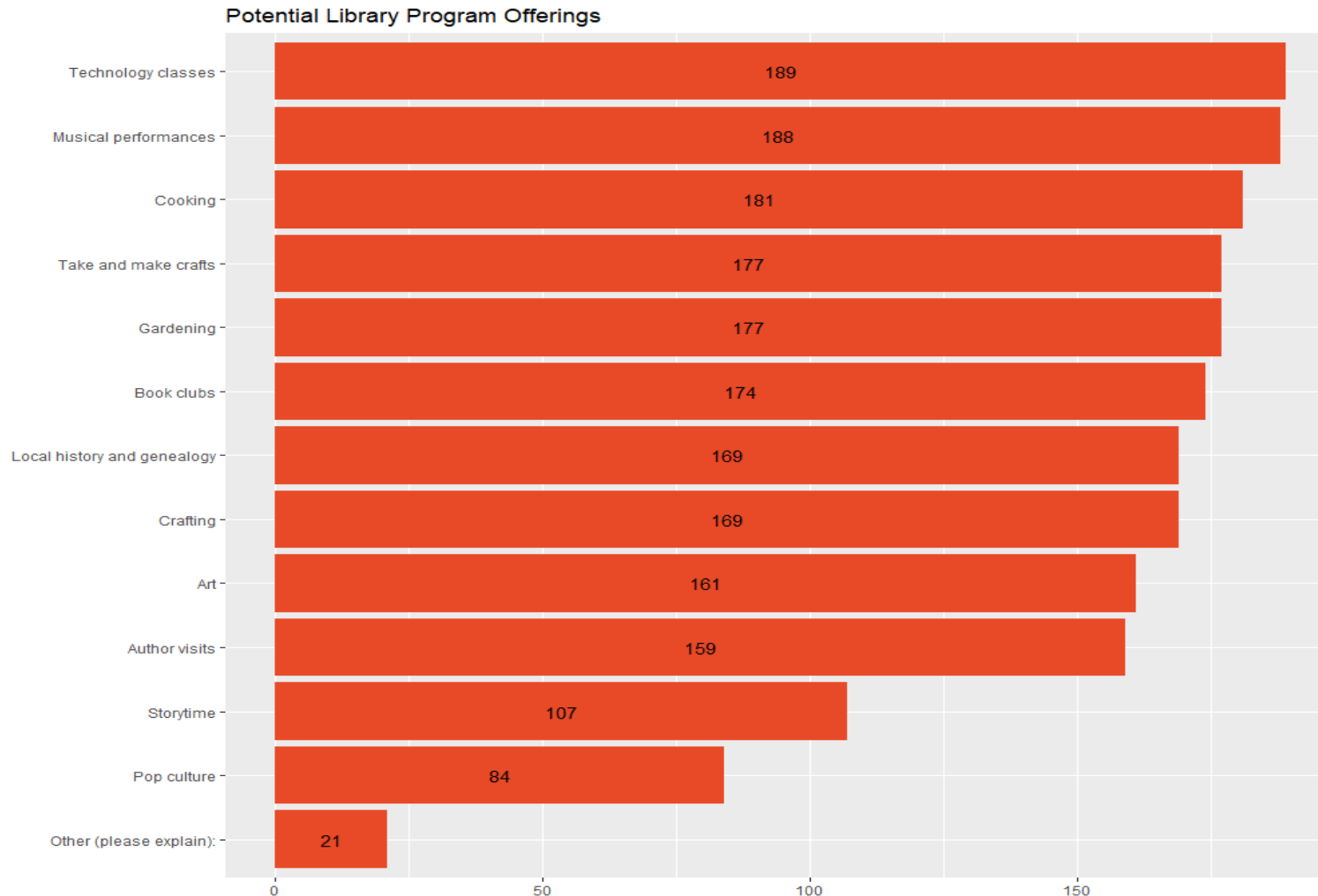
- 21% of respondents used the library at least once a week
- 14% used the library every two weeks
- 21% use the library once per month
- 16.7% utilized the library once every 6 months
- 8.25% of the respondents used the library at least once a year.
- Only 13% reported they never use the library

Reasons Residents Use the Library



- The top reasons individuals used the library is to:
 - borrow fiction books or materials (n=240)
 - Borrow non-fiction books or materials (n=192)
- The least common reason to use the library was to meet friends (n=63)
- Other reasons: checkout e-books, buying books, using the printer, and bringing grandchildren to the library

Potential Library Program Offerings



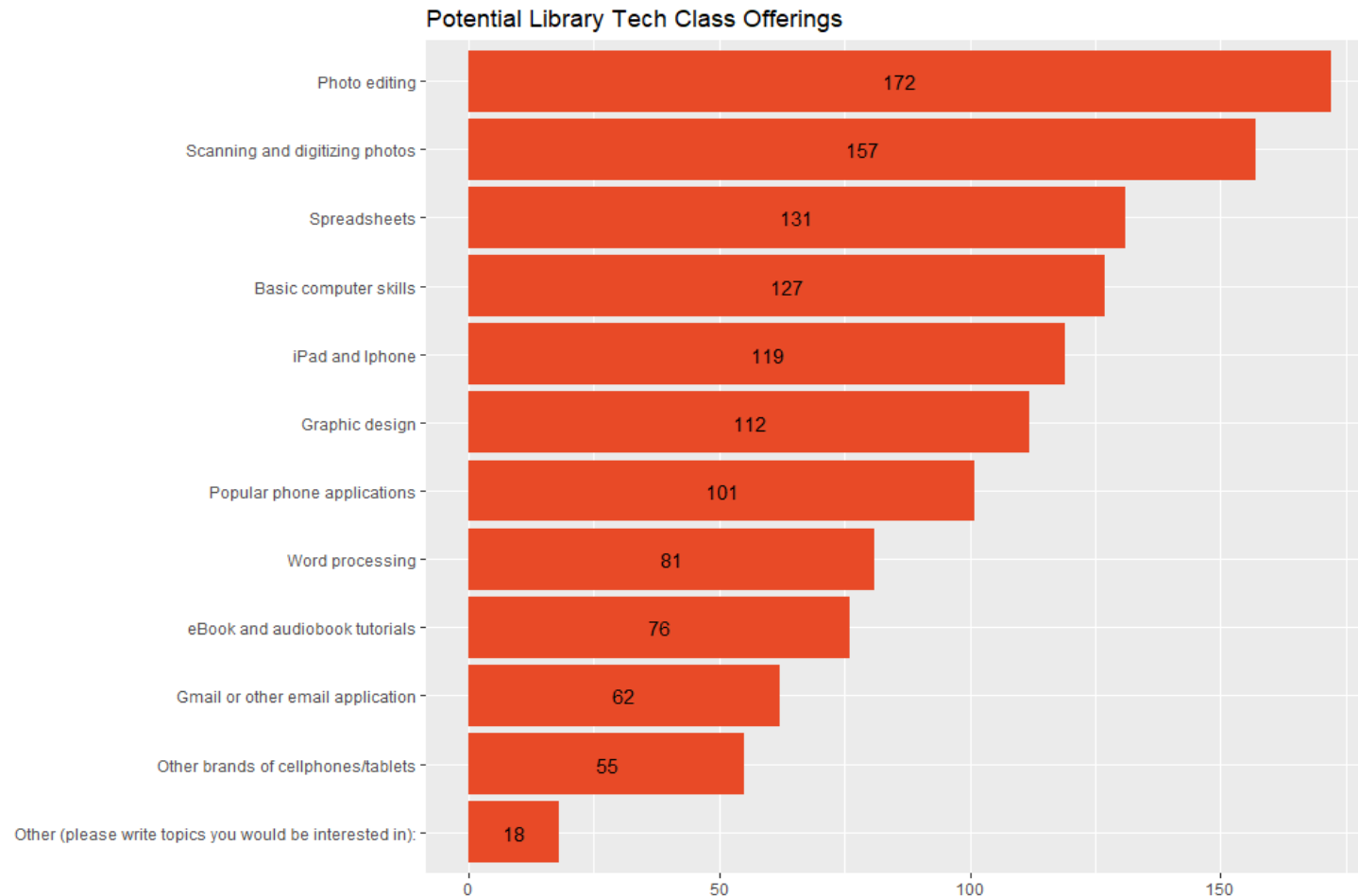
Respondents are most interest in:

- Technology classes
- Musical performances
- Cooking
- Take and make crafts,
- Gardening
- Book clubs
- Genealogy/local history
- Crafting

Least interested:

- Story time
- Pop culture

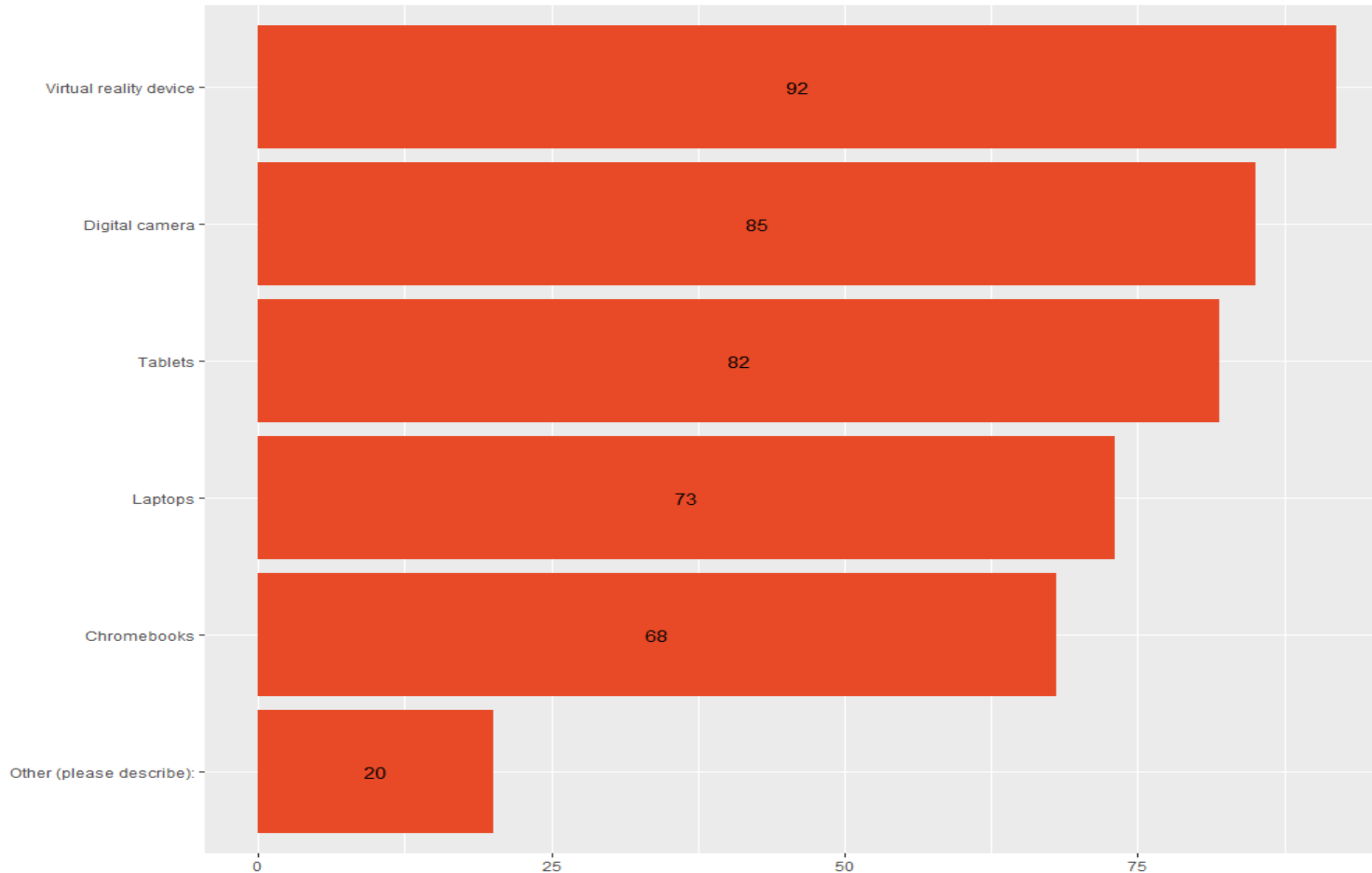
Interest in Library Technology Class Offerings



- Most interested:
 - Photo editing and scanning
 - Digitizing photos
 - Spreadsheets
- Among the potential tech class offerings, Gmail or other email applications and other brands of cellphones/tablets were the least preferred offerings.

Interest in Technology Devices for Checkout

Potential Library Rental Tech Offerings



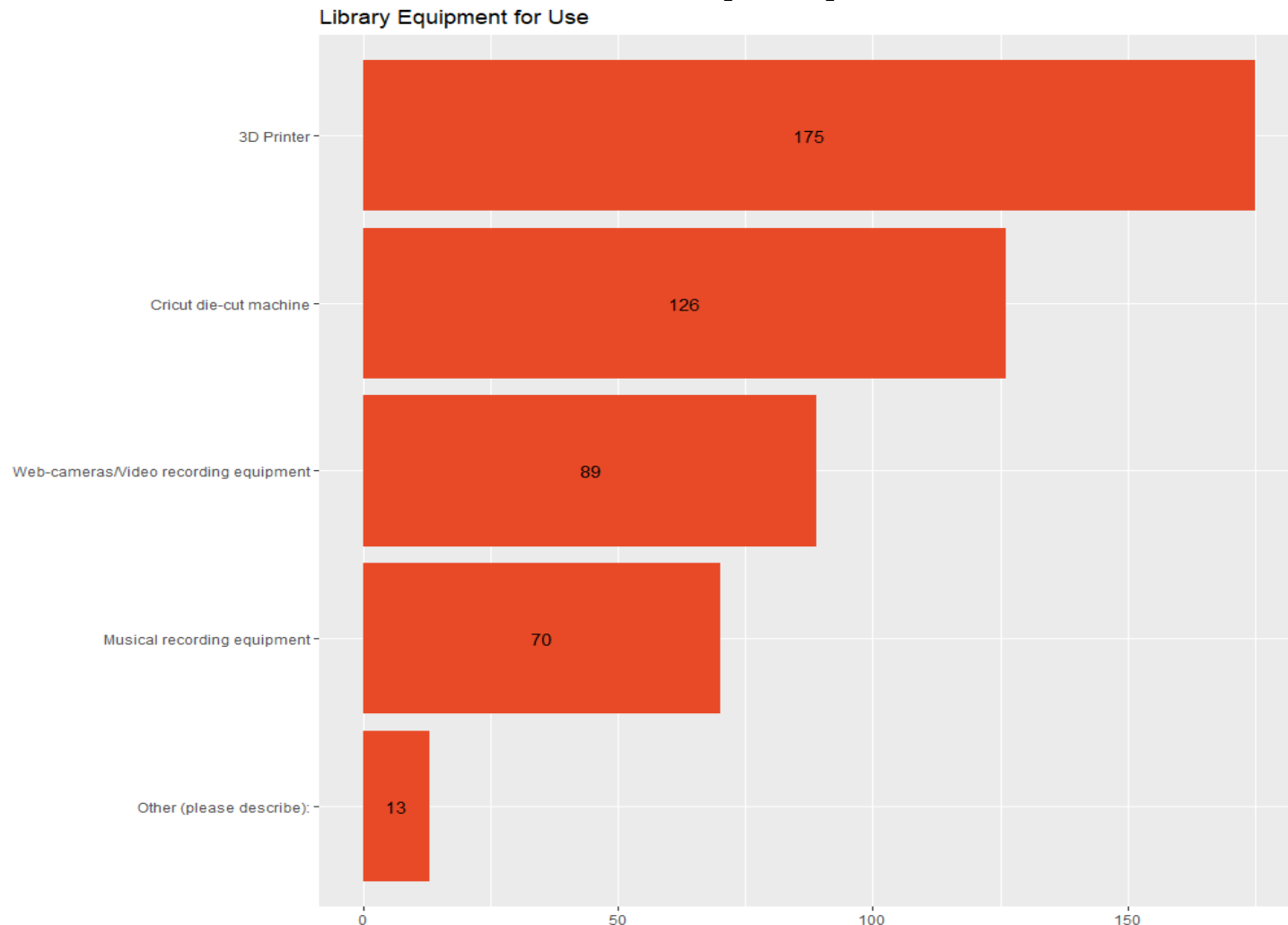
Most interested:

- Virtual reality devices
- Digital cameras
- Tablets
- Laptops

Least interested:

- Chromebooks
- Other (includes gaming systems and printers)

Interest in Equipment for Use



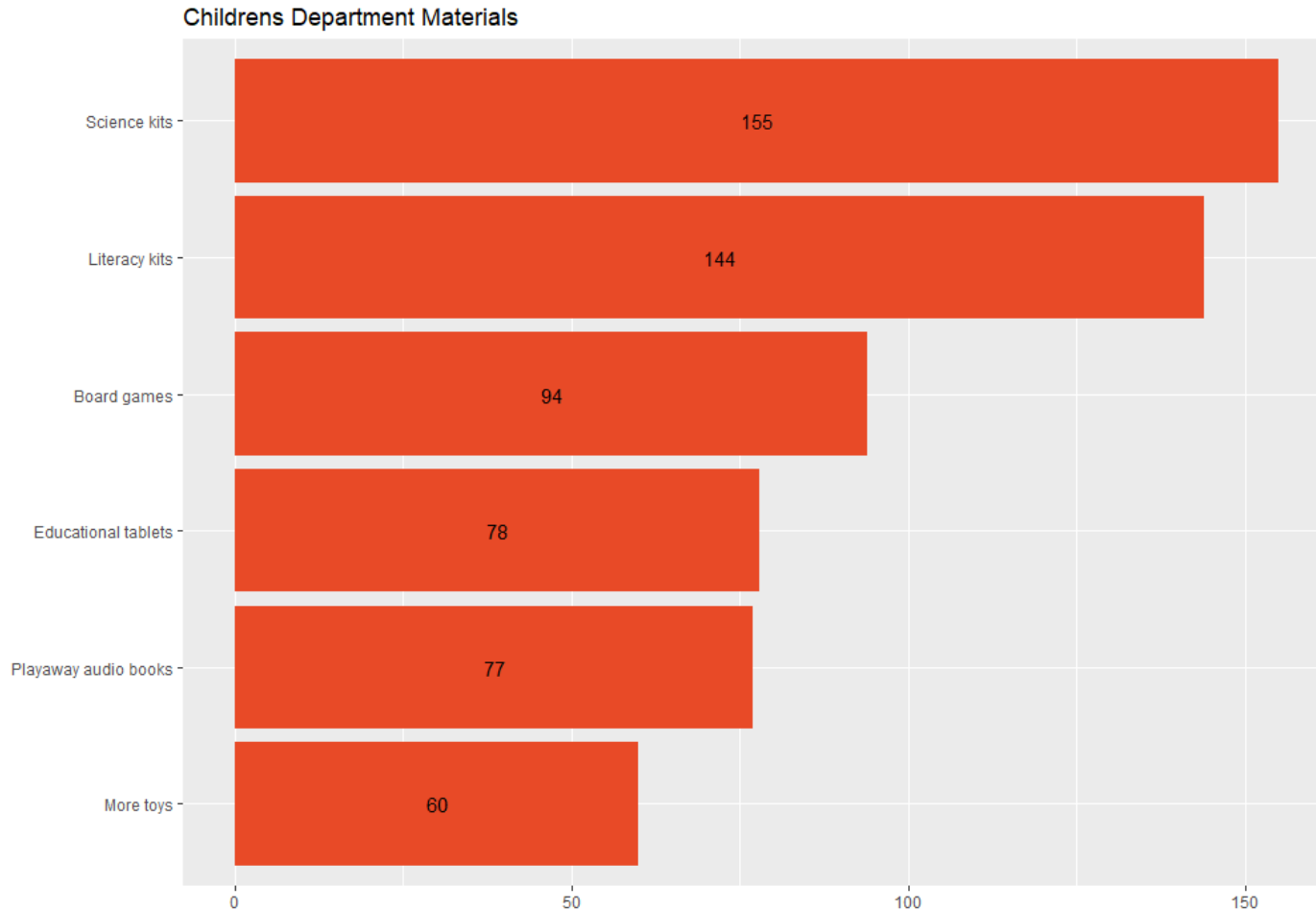
Most interested:

- 3D printer
- Cricut die-cut machine
- Web-cameras/video recording equipment

Least Interested:

- Musical recording equipment
- Other (e.g., Go-Pro cameras, podcast recording equipment)

Interests in Children's Department Materials



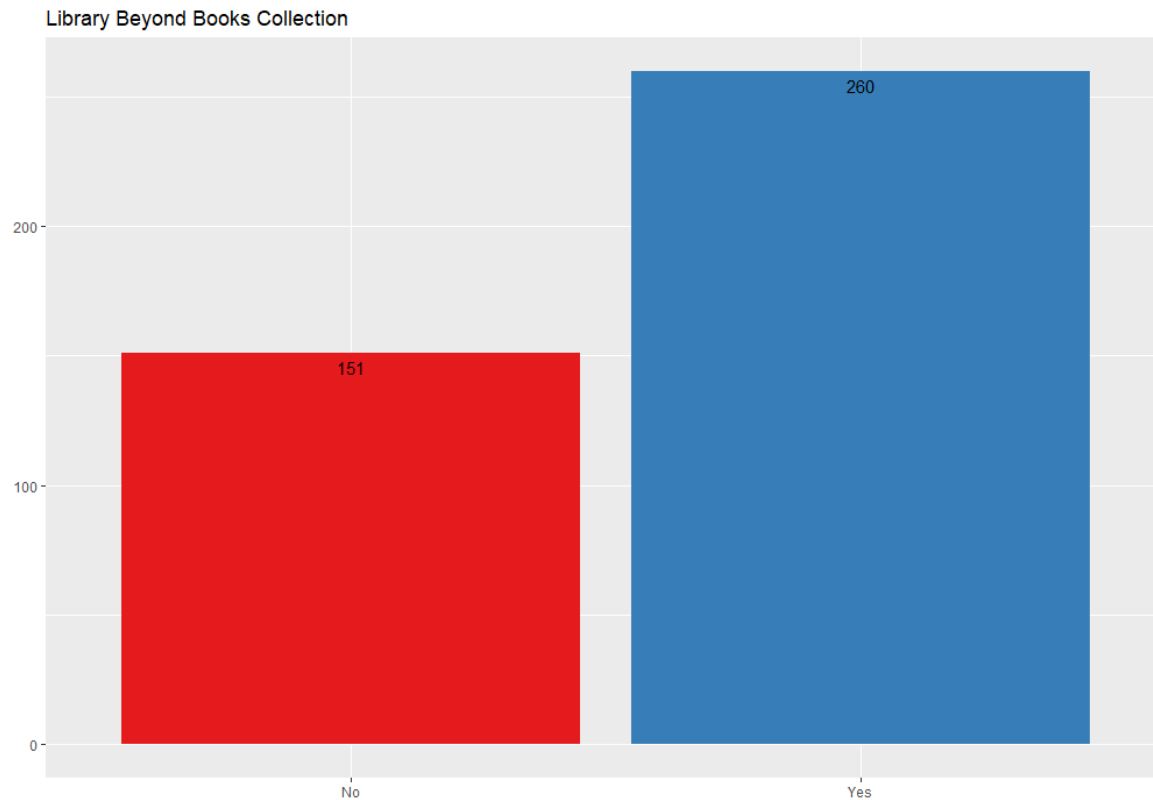
Most interested:

- Science kits
- Literacy kits
- Board games
- Educational tablets
- Play-away audiobooks

Least interested:

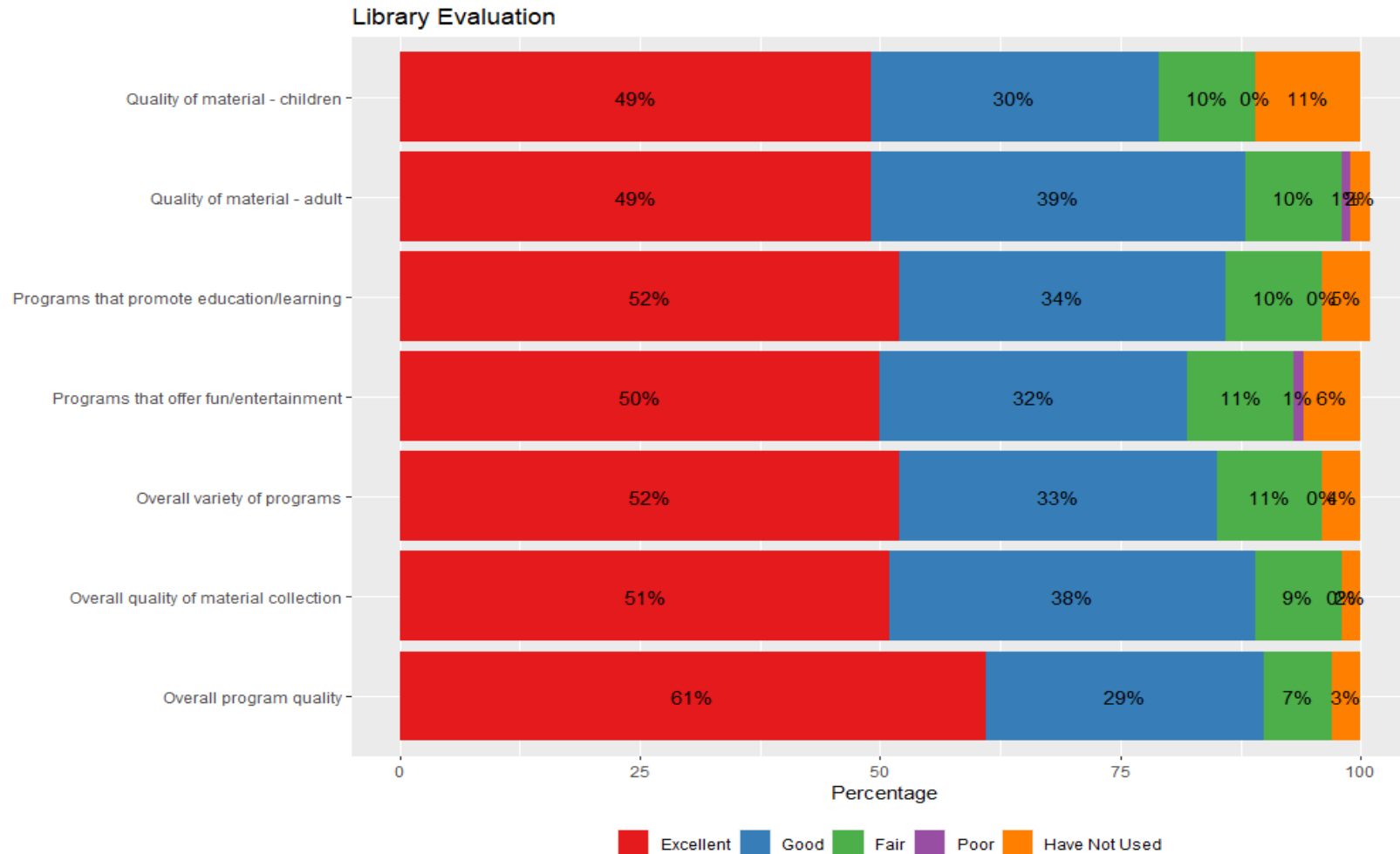
- More toys

Knowledge of the “Beyond Books” Collection



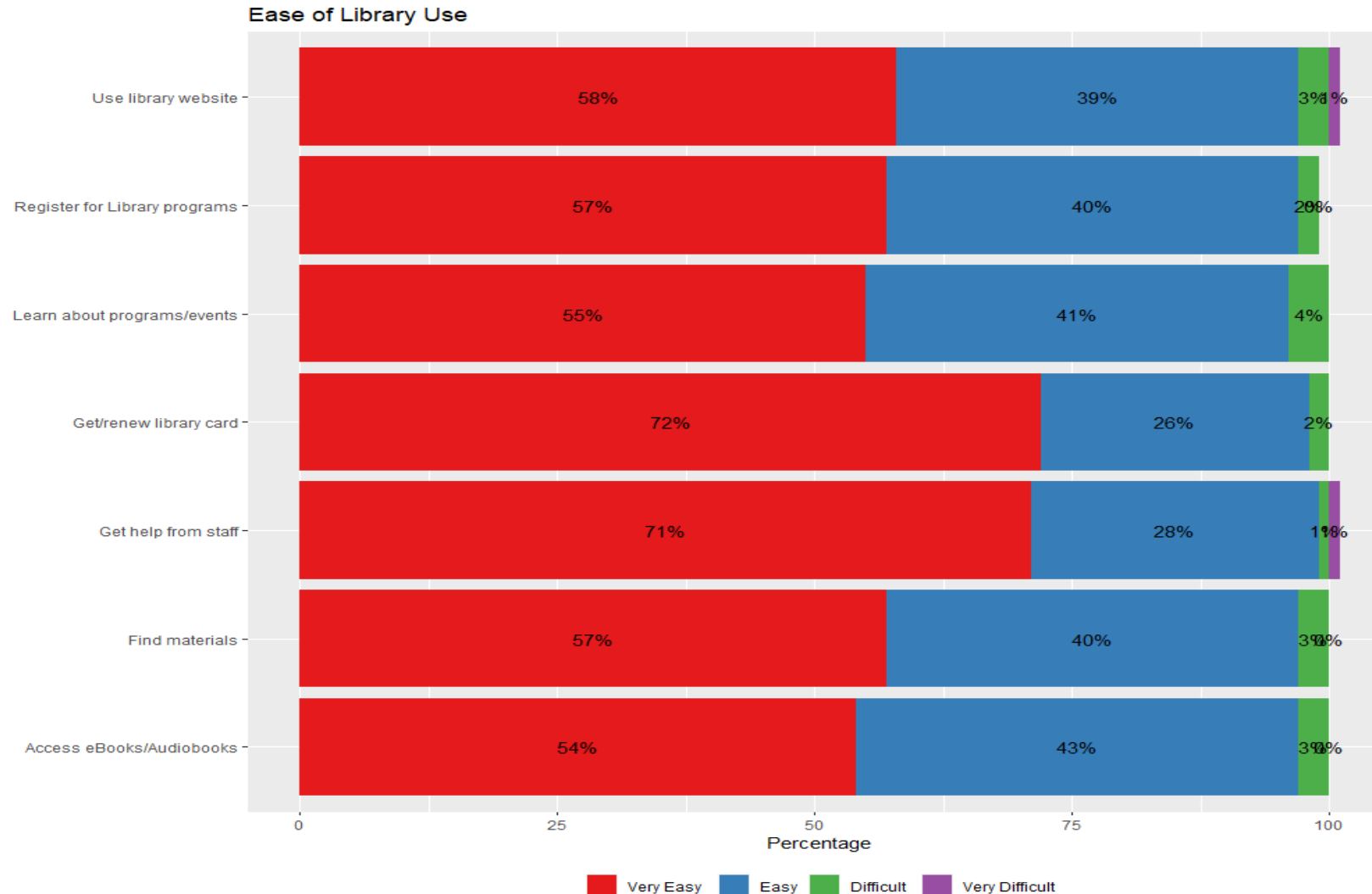
- Among 411 respondents, 63% (N=260) respondents reported that they were aware of the Beyond Books Collection

Overall Quality of Library Programs



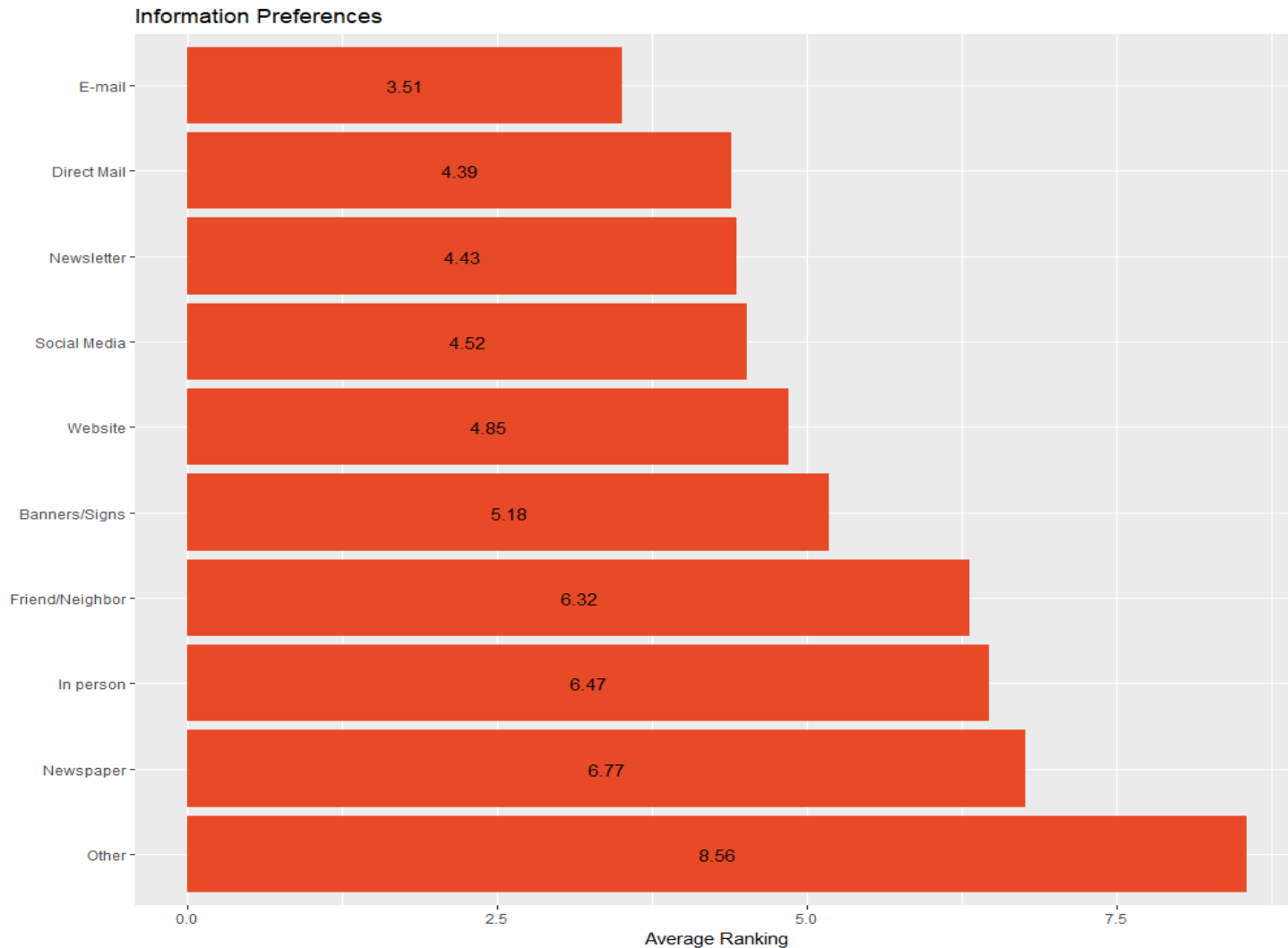
- All of the programs were highly rated by respondents
- 75% or more rated programs are “excellent or good”

Ease of Library Use



- All of the services provided by the library showed high rates of ease of use

Ranked Information Preferences



- Direct mail and Emails were the most preferred ways to receive information
- Newsletter, social media and websites followed

Additional Feedback

Over 100 respondents provided open-ended feedback at the end of the survey

- **Library and Park District:** Many residents conveyed compliments about their experiences with the library and park district. A number of residents did suggested a need for more activities for teens, young adults, and seniors.
- **Crete Bull Dogs:** Many residents suggested additional support for the Crete Bull Dogs and suggested adding a permanent field for the team.
- **Downtown:** Residents are interested in seeing improvements in downtown. A few people mentioned they don't like seeing gambling establishments and that there is a lack of opportunities for families with younger children and teens.
- **Small Town:** Respondents indicated they like the small town feel of Crete. However, a few residents mentioned that higher taxes could make Crete less affordable. Others viewed failed referendums as a barrier to improve Crete.

Community Strengths

Appearance, Cleanliness and Safety:

- Most respondents (70% or more) are satisfied with the cleanliness, safety, and overall appearance of Crete

Parking and Ease of Walking:

- 81% of respondents are “satisfied or completely satisfied” with the ease of public parking in Crete.
- 70% are satisfied with the ease of walking in Crete

A Good Place to Raise a Family:

- Over 70% of respondents are “satisfied or completely satisfied” with Crete as a good place to raise a family.

Community Strengths

Satisfaction with Township Services:

- Respondents indicated they are satisfied with snow removal, branch pick-up and mosquito abatement
- Almost 70% are satisfied with road and bridge maintenance

High Satisfaction with Crete Public Library:

- Respondents are very satisfied with the Crete Public Library
- Many respondents noted the library is a fantastic resource and “vital part of the community”

Community Strengths

Special Events: Well Attended and Highly Rated:

- 70% of respondents attended at least 1 special event
- Rated favorably – 80-95% indicated events were “excellent or good”

Several Parks and Recreation Facilities Rated Favorably:

- Administrative Center, CPD Dance and Fitness Studio and Heritage Sports Complex were highly rated by respondents.
- Crete Park, Lions, Gordon, and Garret Parks were rated “excellent or good” by over 80% of respondents

Recreation Programs:

- Programs are an area of excellence in the park district
- All programs were rated as “excellent or good” by 80% or more of respondents

Community Strengths

Library Programs, Materials, and Ease of Use:

- The library is held in very high regard
- Program quality and quality of materials rated “excellent or good” by 80-90% of respondents
- Respondents rated the library high on ease of use



<https://librarytechnology.org/libraries/search.pl?RecordNumber=IL0123>

Recommendations: Capital Projects

Add Bike Paths and Bike Lanes

- Almost 90% rated “add bike paths” as “very to somewhat important”
- Bikes lanes was ranked second highest among respondents

Build a Multi-Purpose Recreation Center

- Almost 90% indicated a recreation center is “very to somewhat important”
- A recreation center was the top ranked facility to add to Crete

Recommendations: Capital Projects

Add a splash pad/water playground:

- Third ranked capital project
- Rated “very to somewhat important” by 75% of respondents

Park Improvements and ADA Accessibility:

- Update playground equipment at Lincolnshire, Swiss Valley, Crete, Garrett, and possibly Martin Park

Investigate Adding New Stores the Community Would Support:

- Strong interest in general merchandise retailers (e.g., Walmart, Target)
- A grocery store and restaurants are also of interest to respondents

Recommendations: Programs

Invest in More Adult/Senior Programs:

- Life-long learning/educational
- Arts and crafts
- Music
- Outdoor recreation
- Healthy lifestyles/wellness

Youth and Teen Programs:

- More athletic programs
- Cooking
- Special events (e.g., girl's night out)
- E-Sport leagues
- STEAM
- Trivia and escape rooms

Recommendations: Programs

New Library Programs:

- Tech (digital cameras, photo editing/scanning)
- Musical performances
- Cooking
- Gardening
- Genealogy/history

Technology Programs/Devices:

- Cameras/video recording equipment
- Computer skills / spreadsheets
- iPad/iPhone use
- Popular phone apps
- 3D printer

Children's Department Interests:

- Science kits, literacy kits, board games

Thank you!

Questions and Discussion



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